WEST AFRICA

# Les Grands Moulins d’Abidjan (GMA)

**Current State**

March 2026

Corporate Treasury

# WAEMU / UMOA

## Regulatory, Banking, Payment Systems & Monetary Policy Structure

### BANKING SYSTEM — CôTE D'IVOIRE

**Payment System Context**

- BCEAO operates payment infrastructure across all 8 WAEMU states in a context historically marked by cash predominance, high transaction costs, and evolving legislation
- E-money ecosystem has matured significantly over the past decade, with growing cross-border digital services

**Three Reform Pillars (BCEAO)**

**1. STAR-UEMOA (RTGS):** Real-time gross settlement for large-value payments (≥XOF 50M). Currently migrating to ISO 20022.
**2. SICA-UEMOA (ACH):** Automated multilateral clearing for small-value transfers (<XOF 50M), cheques, bills of exchange, and promissory notes.
**3. GIM-UEMOA (Cards):** Regional interbank card processing centre enabling cross-border card acceptance across all 8 member states.

**Reform Objectives**

- Enhance efficiency and safety; reduce transaction lags and costs
- Minimise cash usage; expand access to modern payment instruments
- Promote financial inclusion and deepen regional capital markets
- PI-SPI instant payment platform launched Oct 2025 — full interoperability across banks, MFIs & EMIs

**WAEMU · UMOA**

8 Member States

Benin · Burkina Faso · Côte d'Ivoire
Guinea-Bissau · Mali · Niger
Senegal · Togo

XOF Currency

655.957 XOF/EUR

(fixed since 1999)

**Institution Count (as of 31 Dec 2024)**

- 160 financial institutions across the WAEMU zone (Mar 2025)
- 28 banks + 4 financial institutions operating in Côte d'Ivoire specifically
- Bank categories: universal, regional, corporate, and specialized banks

*Source: BCEAO*
*bceao.int*
*Citibank Country Profile 2025*

*Source: BCEAO (bceao.int) · WAMU Banking Commission (cb-umoa.org) · WAEMU Commission (uemoa.int) · IMF · World Bank*

# France ↔ WAEMU Connectivity — The Monetary Architecture

## FR FRANCE — KEY INSTITUTIONS

### Direction Générale du Trésor (DGT)

*tresor.economie.gouv.fr*

Was direct counterparty for the Operations Account (compte d'opérations) — closed January 2020

NOW: formally stands behind France's convertibility guarantee — purely guarantor of last resort, not operational

Publishes annual Zone franc analytical reports

### Banque de France

*banque-france.fr*

Prints CFA franc banknotes at Chamalières facility under contract with BCEAO

BCEAO decides how many to print — not Banque de France

Technical partner to BCEAO (capacity building, audit); NO longer on BCEAO Board or Monetary Policy Committee

### French Government / Council of State

*diplomatie.gouv.fr*

Guarantor of last resort: if BCEAO cannot honour convertibility, France's guarantee is invoked

Any change to monetary cooperation agreement requires an EU Council decision

## 🌍 WAEMU — POST-2020 STATUS

### Current Structure – Operations account closed

BCEAO no longer deposits reserves at French DGT. BCEAO now freely invests in 32 international accounts across 10 countries and 8 currencies, including one at the US Federal Reserve.

### France withdrawn from BCEAO governance

No French representative on BCEAO Board of Directors or Monetary Policy Committee, except when France's guarantee may be invoked. One independent MPC member appointed in consultation with France.

### Fixed parity UNCHANGED — 655.957 XOF/EUR

The peg to the euro (replacing the French franc peg in 1999) remains unchanged since 1999. This is unchanged by the 2019 reform.

### Currency rename to 'ECO' — not yet implemented

WAEMU authorities indicated intention to rename XOF to 'ECO'. As of early 2026 the rename has NOT occurred. Timing is exclusively WAEMU's sovereign decision.

### Convertibility guarantee — still in force

France still guarantees unlimited convertibility of XOF. This guarantee requires a European Union Council decision to modify — still France's key remaining role.

*Sources: Banque de France — Africa-France Partnerships (banque-france.fr); French DGT — Franc Zone (tresor.economie.gouv.fr/tresor-international/la-zone-franc); French MFA (diplomatie.gouv.fr/en/country-files/africa/franc-zone); Wikipedia WAEMU*

# XOF / EUR Depeg Risk – Ivory Coast

## SCENARIO 1 — Bilateral Mutual Agreement

*BCEAO + EU Council jointly decide to unpeg*

**1 WAMU Political Consensus**

All 8 WAMU heads of state must endorse reform. Requires unanimity in the WAMU Council of Heads of State — a single veto blocks the process.

**2 BCEAO Formal Resolution**

BCEAO Governing Council passes a formal resolution to request regime change. Council of Ministers (Finance Ministers of 8 WAMU members) must ratify.

**3 EU Council Decision**

Under TFEU Article 219(1), the EU Council must act unanimously to modify or dissolve a formal euro exchange-rate arrangement. Every member state holds a veto. ECB must be consulted; European Parliament consulted but not binding.

**4 IMF Article IV & Technical Transition**

IMF engagement required for reserve management, new exchange rate regime design (e.g., managed float or new peg basket). Transition period typically 12–24 months.

## SCENARIO 2 — Unilateral French / EU Withdrawal

*France / EU Council cancel the convertibility guarantee unilaterally*

**1 French Legislative / Executive Decision**

France must formally withdraw the EUR convertibility guarantee and terminate the 1973 Monetary Cooperation Agreement (the Operations Account was closed in 2020; the guarantee itself remains the live obligation). A standard Act of Parliament is required under Art. 53 of the French Constitution for treaties committing state finances — simple majority in the National Assembly suffices.

**2 EU Council Vote**

Per Banque de France / EU Council Decision 98/683/EC, any change to the nature of the agreements — including modification or withdrawal of the French guarantee — requires an EU Council decision. Under TFEU Art. 219(1), that vote must be unanimous. A single veto blocks the amendment.

**3 ECB Monetary Framework Change**

ECB Governing Council must remove XOF from any supervised peg arrangement. This is a technocratic process but requires coordination with EU Presidency and ECOFIN Council. Timeline: 6–12 months minimum.

**4 BCEAO Emergency Response**

Upon guarantee cancellation, BCEAO must immediately float or seek new peg anchor (e.g., USD, SDR basket). Foreign reserves adequacy becomes critical. IMF emergency support may be triggered.

**5 Market & Rating Agency Reaction**

Sovereign downgrades likely for all WAEMU states. Risk of capital flight, FX crisis, inflation shock. Côte d'Ivoire Eurobonds and XOF-denominated debt face repricing.

## KEY INDICATORS TO MONITOR

**FR France**

Political rhetoric on CFA reform · Budget votes on Africa cooperation · Élysée political calendar

**EU EU Council**

ECOFIN agenda items · QMV shifts · ECB supervisory decisions

**🌍 WAMU Region**

Fiscal deficits (>3% GDP) · BCEAO reserve ratio decline · Inflation divergence across WAEMU states

**📊 Markets**

XOF NDF spreads · Ivorian Eurobond spreads · CDS on WAEMU sovereigns

*Sources: TFEU Art. 219(1): eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/treaty/tfeu_2016/art_219 · EU Council Decision 98/683/EC: eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX:31998D0683 · EC Proposal COM(2020)658 amending 98/683/EC: eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/ALL/?uri=CELEX:52020PC0658 · Banque de France — Africa-France partnerships: banque-france.fr/en/banque-de-france/africa-france-partnerships · WAEMU Treaty (Art. 17 consensus): bceao.int/sites/default/files/inline-files/TraiteUMOA2010_tr_Eng.pdf · French Constitution Art. 52-53: conseil-constitutionnel.fr/en/constitution-of-4-october-1958 · 2019 France-WAEMU Cooperation Agreement (French ratification Jan 2021): senat.fr/leg/tas20-052.html · IMF WAEMU 2025 Discussions: imf.org/en/News/Articles/2025/05/06/pr25130 · Fitch upgrades Côte d'Ivoire to BB (Dec 2025): fitchratings.com · WAEMU reserves $33bn/6 months (Fitch/Oct-2025): ecofinagency.com*

# Regional Banking Structure — Governance Hierarchy

**SUPREME AUTHORITY**

## Conference of Heads of State and Government

bceao.int/en/content/conference-heads-state-and-government

Supreme authority · Admits/expels members · Defines major policy orientations (strategic direction and priorities)· Settles matters Council of Ministers cannot – the matters flow upstream.

**EXECUTIVE STEERING**

## Council of Ministers (Conseil des Ministres)

https://www.bceao.int/en/content/council-ministers
https://www.bceao.int/en/content/presentation-wamu

Defines the monetary and credit policy · Sets clearing and payment agreements with foreign central banks · Votes on items based on the WAMU Treaty and Statutes of the BCEAO
This body is composed primarily of the Ministers of Finance for each member state

cb-umoa.org/en/missions-and-objectives

**CENTRAL BANK / ENFORCEMENT**

## BCEAO (Central Bank)

Drafts regulations · Issues currency · Monetary policy · Operates STAR/SICA
Manages reserves · General Secretariat of WAMU Banking Commission
Consists of the following statutory bodies: The Governor, The Monetary Policy Committee, The Board of Directors, The Audit Committee, National Credit Councils

Central Bank Site: https://www.bceao.int/en/content/presentation-bceao
Regulations posted: Réglementations | Banque Centrale des Etats de l'Afrique de l'Ouest (BCEAO)

## WAMU Banking Commission

Licenses & supervises all banks and regulated institutions · Issues sanctions · Resolution authority for banking crises.
Separated into the Supervisory Board (regulatory) and the Resolution College (crisis avoidance).
Members: Composition | Commission Bancaire de l'UMOA
Regulations Posted: Regulation | UMOA

**OPERATIONAL BODIES**

### WAEMU Commission

Executes budget · Publishes Official Bulletin of the Union · Oversees economic integration and decide how much currency is put into ciruclation

Members of WEAMU: The organs of l'UEMOA | UEMOA
uemoa.int
The Commission | UEMOA

### UMOA-Titres (AUT)

T-bill/T-bond auction coordination · Assists Treasuries in capital markets

umoatitres.org

### CREPMF

Regional capital markets regulator · Licenses & supervises BRVM stock exchange

crepmf.org

### BOAD (Dev. Bank)

Development financing · Infrastructure projects across WAEMU · Lomé, Togo

boad.org

*Source: BCEAO — Presentation of WAMU (bceao.int/en/content/presentation-wamu) · BOAD Roles of WAEMU Organs (boad.org) · WAMU Banking Commission (cb-umoa.org)*

# BCEAO — All Institutions & Counterparties

*Every institution the BCEAO formally works with, organized by relationship type. Sources: BCEAO STAR-UEMOA, SICA-UEMOA, Payment Systems Mgmt · World Bank WAEMU FSAP 2022 · BCEAO Annual Report 2023.*

## STAR-UEMOA Direct Participants

*Per BCEAO STAR-UEMOA page — eligible participants*

- BCEAO (Operator) — Operator & direct participant. Processes monetary policy, refinancing, primary market, FX, and cash transactions through its own participant account.
- Commercial Banks & Financial Institutions — All licensed banks in WAEMU (~160). Direct or indirect participation via BCEAO Main Branch service desk.
- National Public Treasuries (8 states) — Treasuries of all 8 WAEMU states. Use STAR for government payments and SAGETIL for public debt operations.
- BRVM Central Depository / Settlement Bank — Dépositaire Central / Banque de Règlement de la BRVM. Settles regional stock exchange securities transactions through STAR-UEMOA.
- GIM-UEMOA SA — Interbank card/electronic switch. Holds its own STAR participant account for end-of-day settlement of net card and electronic payment balances.
- BOAD / WADB (West African Dev. Bank) — Banque Ouest Africaine de Développement. STAR participant for its own cross-border financial transactions within the WAEMU zone.

## SICA-UEMOA Participants

*Per BCEAO SICA-UEMOA page — authorized participants only*

- BCEAO (Operator) — Operates SICA and participates directly. Sets clearing rules, controls exchange day schedules, and manages net balance settlement via STAR.
- Commercial Banks — All licensed banks. Submit daily payment files (transfers, cheques, bills of exchange, promissory notes, draw-down notices) for multilateral netting.
- National Public Treasuries (8 states) — All 8 national treasuries participate in SICA for government retail payment processing.
- Postal Financial Services (La Poste) — National postal services of all 8 states. Eligible under Règlement 15/2002. Process savings, money orders, and remittances through SICA.

## Regulatory & Supervisory Counterparties

*Institutions the BCEAO coordinates with for financial system oversight*

- WAMU Banking Commission (CB-UMOA) — BCEAO serves as General Secretariat. Joint supervision of all credit institutions — licensing, sanctions, resolution. cb-umoa.org
- CREPMF — Regional Council for Public Savings & Financial Markets. Capital markets regulator — supervises BRVM. Coordinates with BCEAO on systemic risk.
- FGDR-UMOA — Deposit Guarantee and Resolution Fund. BCEAO coordinates on bank resolution cases across all 8 member states.
- WAEMU Financial Stability Committee — Inter-regulatory body: BCEAO, Banking Commission, CREPMF and others. Monitors systemic risk and macro-prudential policy.
- CIMA (Insurance Markets) — Inter-African Conference on Insurance Markets. Insurance regulator. BCEAO financial stability mandate extends to insurer exposures.
- CIPRES (Social Security) — Inter-African Conference on Social Security. Social security regulator. BCEAO monitors large fund exposures for financial stability.
- BIC — Regional Credit Bureau — Regional Credit Reporting Bureau. BCEAO cooperates on credit information sharing to reduce credit risk and support lending.
- CRRH — Regional Mortgage Fund — Caisse Régionale de Refinancement Hypothécaire. Refinances mortgage portfolios of member banks within the WAEMU framework.

## International & Partner Institutions

*External bodies the BCEAO formally engages with*

- Banque de France — Prints CFA franc banknotes under contract. France guarantees XOF convertibility via the French Treasury. Under the Dec. 2019 reform (ratified France May 2020, effective 2021), the BCEAO's Operations Account at the French Treasury was closed — BCEAO now manages its own reserves directly. France no longer appoints a representative to BCEAO governing bodies (except when guarantee may be invoked).
- French DGT (Trésor) — Direction Générale du Trésor. Administers France's unlimited convertibility guarantee — legal guarantor of the fixed 655.957 XOF/EUR peg. Since 2021, the BCEAO's reserves are no longer deposited at the French Treasury; the guarantee now operates as a backstop credit line.
- IMF — Regular Article IV consultations, FSAP assessments, technical assistance on monetary policy, reserves, and financial stability. imf.org
- World Bank / IDA — Development finance and technical assistance. Co-funded WAEMU payment systems infrastructure. Active on financial inclusion. worldbank.org
- BOAD (Development Bank) — West African Development Bank. BCEAO coordinates on regional development financing and monetary policy transmission. boad.org
- UMOA-Titres (AUT) — WAEMU Securities Agency. Coordinates T-bill/T-bond issuance. BCEAO is the settlement bank for primary market operations via SAGETIL-UMOA. umoatitres.org

*Sources: BCEAO STAR-UEMOA · BCEAO SICA-UEMOA · BCEAO Payment Systems Mgmt (bceao.int) · BCEAO Annual Report 2023 · World Bank WAEMU FSAP 2022 · cb-umoa.org · umoatitres.org · boad.org*

# Financial Institutions — Types, Descriptions & Regulators

- *Licensed by: WAMU Banking Commission + Minister of Finance*
- *Licensed by: BCEAO (directly)*
- *Licensed by: National Ministry of Finance + BCEAO opinion*

## A — Commercial Banks

*Banques*

Full-service credit institutions: deposit-taking, lending, trade finance, FX, card issuance. ~132 banks (out of ~155 total credit institutions) in WAEMU at end-2022 (IMF 2024). Min. capital: XOF 20bn from Jan 1, 2024. Examples: Ecobank, Coris Bank, Société Générale, BNP Paribas, Attijariwafa, BOA.

*Regulator: WAMU Banking Commission + Minister of Finance · cb-umoa.org*

## B — Financial Companies

*Établissements Financiers*

Subset of banking: leasing, consumer credit, factoring, specialised investment. NOT authorised to take public deposits. Distinct Banking Commission approval required.

*Regulator: WAMU Banking Commission + Minister of Finance · cb-umoa.org*

## C — Microfinance / SFDs

*Systèmes Financiers Décentralisés*

Critical for financial inclusion. Serve low-income individuals, small businesses, rural communities. ~77% of all WAEMU financial institutions by count. Separate regulatory framework from full Banking Law.

*Regulator: National Ministry of Finance + BCEAO opinion · bceao.int*

## D — Electronic Money Institutions

*Établissements de Monnaie Électronique (EMI)*

Issue e-wallets and mobile money. CANNOT grant credit or pay interest on balances. Must segregate customer funds. Major players: Orange Money, MTN Mobile Money, Wave, Moov Money, Free Money.

*Regulator: BCEAO (directly) · bceao.int — EMIs*

## E — Payment Institutions

*Établissements de Paiement (NEW — 2024)*

New category under BCEAO Instruction 001-01-2024 (eff. Jan. 23, 2024). Payment services without full banking/EMI licence. Licences are country-by-country.

*Regulator: BCEAO (directly) · bceao.int*

## F — Postal Financial Services

*Services Financiers Postaux*

National postal services provide savings, money orders, remittances. Eligible SICA-UEMOA participants. Subject to BCEAO oversight. Serve underbanked rural populations.

*Regulator: BCEAO oversight · bceao.int — SICA*

*Sources: BCEAO (bceao.int) · WAMU Banking Commission (cb-umoa.org/en/missions-and-objectives) · Chambers Banking Regulation 2026 Senegal · BCEAO Instruction 001-01-2024 · World Bank WAEMU FSAP 2022, CITI Country Profile 2025*

# Legislation Governing Payment Systems & Banking

*Regulatory hierarchy: Traités → Lois Uniformes → Règlements → Décisions → Instructions → Circulaires → Avis*

### Loi Uniforme Bancaire

**June 16, 2023**

*Issuer: WAMU Council of Ministers*

Foundational banking law. Defines all institution categories, licensing framework, resolution regime, and FinTech provisions. Cross-border single licence (agrément unique) across all 8 states. Replaces 2007 law.

*↗ bceao.int — Réglementation Bancaire*

### Règlement n°15/2002/CM/UEMOA

**Sept. 19, 2002**

*Issuer: WAMU Council of Ministers*

Foundational payment systems regulation. Establishes BCEAO as exclusive payment oversight authority. Legal basis for STAR-UEMOA (RTGS) and SICA-UEMOA (ACH). Irrevocability/finality of settled payments.

*↗ bceao.int — Payment Systems Regulations*

### Instruction n°001-01-2024

**Jan. 23, 2024 (eff. May 2025)**

*Issuer: BCEAO Governor*

Creates the Payment Institution (Établissement de Paiement) licence category. Defines all regulated payment services. Sets minimum capital: XOF 10M–300M+. Client funds must be 100% segregated. AML/CFT mandatory.

*↗ bceao.int — Instruction 001-01-2024*

### Instruction n°008-05-2015 (EMI)

**May 21, 2015**

*Issuer: BCEAO Governor*

Governs all EMIs. Non-banks must obtain formal agrément. 75% of outstanding e-money must be held in sight deposits at licensed banks. Prohibits credit and interest on e-money balances. 3-pillar oversight.

*↗ bceao.int — Instruction 008-05-2015*

### Loi Uniforme LBC/FT/FP (AML/CFT)

**July 2015 · Revised March 2023**

*Issuer: WAMU Council of Ministers*

AML/CFT law for all regulated institutions. KYC, enhanced CDD for PEPs and cross-border transactions. Mandatory STR reporting to CENTIF. 5-year record retention. Aligned with FATF 2022 Recommendations.

*↗ bceao.int — LBC/FT/FP*

### Règlement n°06/2024 (FX Controls)

**Dec. 20, 2024**

*Issuer: WAEMU Council of Ministers*

New foreign exchange regulation replacing 2010 rules. Mandatory domiciliation of large trade transactions. Repatriation of export proceeds. Prior authorisation for large outbound investments. 12 implementing Instructions (July 2025).

*↗ bceao.int — Règlement 06/2024*

*All primary sources: BCEAO (bceao.int/fr/reglementations) · WAMU Banking Commission (cb-umoa.org) · Chambers Global Practice Guides 2026 · IMF WAEMU FSAP 2022*

# BCEAO-Operated Payment Systems — Architecture

*Per Article 3, Règlement n°15/2002: the BCEAO is formally responsible for STAR-UEMOA (RTGS) and SICA-UEMOA (ACH) only. SICA net positions clear daily into STAR.*

## STAR-UEMOA

***Real-Time Gross Settlement (RTGS)***

Launched June 25, 2004 · Operated by BCEAO HQ Dakar · SWIFT format
Cutoff Time: 5:00 pm (banks will have their own internal cutoff times – CITI is 3:30 pm)

**PURPOSE**

Large-value & urgent interbank transfers. Settlement backbone for the entire WAEMU financial system. Each payment settles individually and irrevocably — no netting.

**THRESHOLD & FORMAT**

Mandatory for transfers ≥ XOF 50M. Urgent transfers of any amount. SWIFT-based orders. Avg. completion ~41 seconds.

**PARTICIPANTS (per BCEAO)**

BCEAO · Banks & financial institutions · National Public Treasuries (8 states) · BRVM/DC/BR · GIM-UEMOA SA · BOAD

**INSTRUMENTS CLEARED & SETTLEMENT TIMING**

- Domestic Funds Transfer (ACH, DFT, Wire) > XOF 50M — D+0 (same-day net if prior to 3:00)
- RTGS (Real Time Gross Settlement) > XOF 50M — D+0 (same-day net if prior to 3:00 or 5:00)
- SICA-UEMOA multilateral net clearing positions (end-of-day net positions)
- GIM-UEMOA interbank card & electronic switch balances (end-of-day net positions)
- BRVM stock exchange cash settlement (via DC/BR) (end-of-day net positions)
- BCEAO monetary policy & open market operations (end-of-day net positions)
- National Treasury intraday liquidity operations (end-of-day net positions)

*↗ bceao.int/en/content/star-uemoa*

## SICA-UEMOA: Paper & Low Value Electronic

***Automated Clearing House (ACH)***

Launched Nov. 17, 2005 (Mali pilot) · Full 8-country: Feb. 14, 2008
CITI Cutoff time: 3:30 pm

**PURPOSE**

Retail multilateral netting. Processes bulk cashless instruments daily between banks, treasuries and postal services across all 8 states.

**STRUCTURE & SESSION**

9 sub-systems: 8 national + 1 regional cross-border. Single daily session. BCEAO does not publicly disclose the exact cutoff time.

**PARTICIPANTS**

BCEAO · Banks · National Public Treasuries (8 states) · Postal Financial Services. MFIs & EMIs settle indirectly via their bank.

**INSTRUMENTS CLEARED & SETTLEMENT TIMING:**

- Domestic Funds Transfers (ACH, DFT, Wire) < XOF 50M — D+0 (same-day net if prior to 3:00)
- Cheques (7 types, ISO format) — D+1 (Citibank D+2 if prior to 2:30)
- Bills of exchange & promissory notes — D+1
- Draw-down notices / direct debits (prélèvements) — D+0 to D+1
- Postal financial service transactions — D+1

*↗ bceao.int/en/content/sica-uemoa*

*Sources: BCEAO STAR-UEMOA (bceao.int/en/content/star-uemoa) · BCEAO SICA-UEMOA (bceao.int/en/content/sica-uemoa) · BCEAO Payment Systems Management · Règlement n°15/2002/CM/UEMOA, Citibank Country Profile 2025*

# Payment Instruments — Descriptions & Sources

## PAPER-BASED

### Cheques (Chèques)
7 types: ordinary, certified, bank/cashier's, crossed, non-negotiable, order, bearer. Standardised under 2010 SICA-UEMOA update (ISO format). Cleared through SICA-UEMOA.

↗ *bceao.int — SICA*

### Bills of Exchange
Commercial credit instrument: drawer orders drawee to pay a specified sum on a specified date. Widely used for trade finance within WAEMU. No XOF 50M cap in SICA.

↗ *bceao.int — SICA*

### Promissory Notes
Unconditional written promise to pay a specified sum on demand or future date. Common in SME financing and interbank arrangements. Cleared through SICA-UEMOA.

↗ *bceao.int — SICA*

### Cash

## CARD-BASED

### Debit Card
Linked directly to bank account. Most widely issued card type in WAEMU. Used at ATMs (DAB) and POS terminals. Operates within GIM-UEMOA scheme.

↗ *cb-umoa.org*

### Credit Card
Monthly repayment with or without interest. Less common than debit in WAEMU due to lower formal banking penetration.

↗ *cb-umoa.org*

### Prepaid Card
Loaded with a fixed amount in advance. No bank account required — financial inclusion tool. GIM-UEMOA received EMI licence in 2008 to issue prepaid cards regionally.

↗ *cb-umoa.org*

### Virtual / ATM Card
Virtual cards used for online/e-commerce payments (growing with e-commerce expansion). ATM-only withdrawal cards common in entry-level accounts.

↗ *cb-umoa.org*

## ELECTRONIC & DIGITAL

### Mobile Money (EMIs)
Dominant retail payment innovation. >70% of adults in Senegal have mobile money access. Operators: Orange Money, MTN, Wave, Moov Money, Free Money. Transactions: P2P, merchant, bills, government disbursements.

↗ *bceao.int — EMI Instruction*

### Direct Debits
Pre-authorised debit instructions (loan repayments, utility bills). Cleared through SICA-UEMOA as 'draw-down notices' (avis de prélèvements). Authorised by account holder in advance.

↗ *bceao.int — SICA*

### PI-SPI Instant Payments
New 24/7 real-time interoperable payment channel launched October 2025. Full interoperability: banks, MFIs, EMIs on single infrastructure. 45 institutions at launch.

↗ *bceao.int (BCEAO-operated)*

### e-CFA (CBDC — In Development)
BCEAO developing retail Central Bank Digital Currency legally equivalent to CFA franc. Proof-of-concept underway. No official launch date as of early 2026. PI-SPI is foundational infrastructure.

↗ *bceao.int*

### ACH / RTGS Transfers
Domestic (<XOF 50M via SICA; ≥XOF 50M or urgent via STAR). Intra-WAEMU (regional SICA). International (BCEAO or licensed intermediary; FX regulations apply; MoF auth for large amounts).

↗ *bceao.int — STAR*

*Sources: BCEAO SICA-UEMOA (bceao.int/en/content/sica-uemoa) · BCEAO STAR-UEMOA (bceao.int/en/content/star-uemoa) · BCEAO Instruction 008-05-2015 · GIM-UEMOA*

# Share of Recorded Electronic Payment Value (2023)

SOURCE: BCEAO OFFICIAL REPORTS · RAPPORT IMF 2022–2023 · RAPPORT SFN 2023

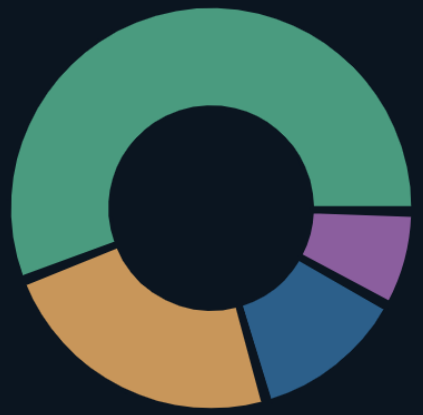
## UEMOA Payment Systems Dashboard

Transaction flows by clearing infrastructure · 2023

⚠ **Note:** Cash transactions are excluded — they settle at point of exchange with no clearing system. STAR-UEMOA value is an approximation. All values in billions of CFA francs.

| MOBILE MONEY | SICA-UEMOA | STAR-UEMOA | GIM-UEMOA |
|---|---|---|---|
| 130tn | 53,813bn | 28,000bn | 16,886bn |
| FCFA · 2023 | FCFA · 2023 | FCFA · 2023 | FCFA · 2023 |
| Orange, MTN, Wave & other e-money platforms | Interbank clearing: cheques, transfers, direct debits | Large-value real-time gross settlement (~estimate) | Interbank card payments (monétique) |

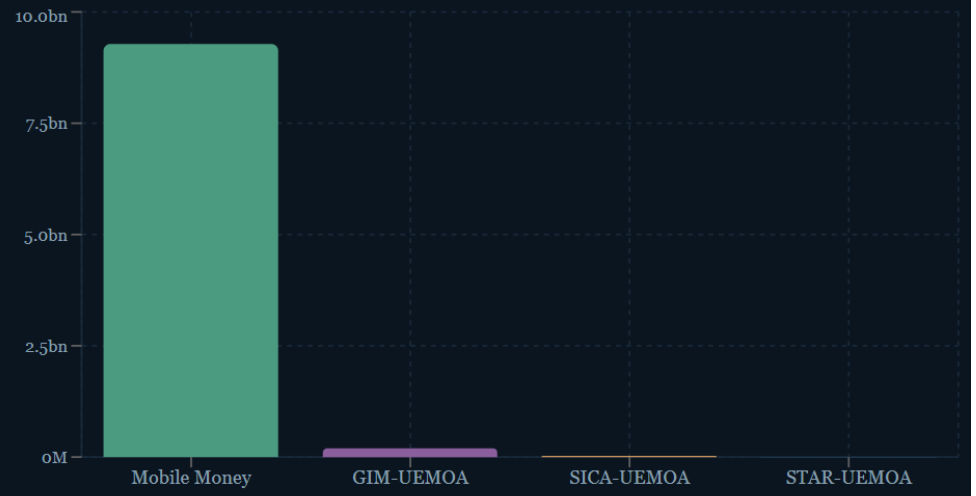
Share of total recorded electronic payment value (2023)



- Mobile Money — 56.9% · 130,150 bn FCFA
- SICA-UEMOA — 23.5% · 53,813 bn FCFA
- STAR-UEMOA — 12.2% · 28,000 bn FCFA
- GIM-UEMOA — 7.4% · 16,886 bn FCFA

Total recorded electronic
**228,849 bn FCFA**

Transaction volume by system (millions of transactions, 2023)



# EMI & PI-SPI Interconnectivity

## EMIs

*Electronic Money Institutions (Licensed by BCEAO)*

### Active Operators (2025)

- Orange Money (market leader)
- MTN Mobile Money
- Moov Money (Maroc Telecom)
- Wave (US fintech, EMI licence)

### Regulatory Framework

- BCEAO Instruction 008-05-2015
- (e-money licensing)
- Updated by Instruction 001-01-2024
- (payment services)
- Must segregate customer funds
- No credit / no interest on balances
- KYC required; AML reports to CENTIF

*Regulated & supervised by BCEAO*

Transaction flow

## PI-SPI

*Plateforme Interopérable du Système de Paiement Instantané*

### What it does

- Retail interoperable instant payments
- Connects banks, EMIs & microfinance
- Transfers settled in < 10 seconds, 24/7
- Alias-based (phone no. / QR code)
- Free transfers for individuals
- CFA franc only; all 8 UEMOA countries

### Transaction Limits

- No hard BCEAO ceiling per PI-SPI transaction
- Individual limits set by each participant institution based on account tier & KYC level
- Launched Sept 30, 2025 (15 Ivorian participants as of Feb 2026)

*Designed & operated by BCEAO*

Settlement instructions

## STAR-UEMOA

*Système de Transfert Automatisé et de Règlement*

### Role in context of PI-SPI

- RTGS: final settlement of net positions from clearing systems incl. SICA-UEMOA
- PI-SPI net balances ultimately settle via STAR (BCEAO manages both end-to-end)
- Handles large-value / systemically important flows (transfers ≥ XOF 50M routed here via SICA rules)
- Participant banks hold settlement accounts at BCEAO / STAR
- SWIFT-based; operating hours 08:00–17:20 GMT
- Intra-day advances available to maintain payment fluidity

*Final settlement backbone — BCEAO operated*

**PI-SPI Business:** PI-SPI API Business is a standardized REST API operated by the BCEAO that allows companies to integrate once and send or receive instant payments to and from any bank, mobile money operator, or microfinance institution across all 8 UEMOA countries — without needing separate agreements with each provider. It supports use cases including alias-based payments, interoperable QR code acceptance, Request-to-Pay flows, and real-time webhook notifications for automated reconciliation, all built on ISO 20022 messaging with OAuth2/mTLS security.

PI-SPI Sandbox - Business API Test Environment

# PI-SPI API Business — Integration Architecture, Mobile Money Flow & Business Risk Register

## API BUSINESS — WHAT IT ENABLES

### Single Integration

One REST/JSON API → reach all PI-SPI participants (banks, EMIs, MFIs) across 8 UEMOA countries. No bilateral agreements needed.

### Alias & QR Routing

Customers pay via phone number alias or interoperable QR code. Alias resolution is instant; no IBAN required.

### Request-to-Pay (RTP)

Business sends a payment request to the customer's mobile app. Customer reviews & approves. Funds credited in < 10 seconds.

### Webhooks & Reconciliation

Real-time push notifications on payment events. Automates ERP/CRM reconciliation; eliminates manual matching.

## MOBILE MONEY CUSTOMER FLOW (e.g. Orange Money → Business)

1. *PIN/biometric auth in EMI app*
2. *Alias resolved AML pre-screen*
3. *Webhook fires < 10 seconds*
4. *End-of-day final settlement*

**Tech:** ISO 20022 · REST/JSON · OAuth2 + mTLS · AES-256 · Sandbox: developer.pispi.bceao.int

## RISK REGISTER — KEY CONSIDERATIONS FOR BUSINESS ONBOARDING

### KYC & Identity Risk

BCEAO applies tiered, risk-based KYC. Low-tier mobile money accounts have lighter identity checks — per Instruction 001-01-2024 (in force May 2025), full CDD is mandatory but simplified measures apply at lower value tiers.

Business obligation: verify your participant EMI is 001-01-2024 compliant. For high-value or recurring customers, add an independent KYC layer — you cannot rely solely on the EMI's onboarding quality.

### Anonymity / Alias Risk

Payments arrive as a phone-number alias. Alias resolution confirms the EMI account but does not expose the customer's verified identity to the receiving business. Beneficial-owner visibility is limited to what the EMI has recorded.

Per BCEAO FAQ, the alias system lets customers transact 'without sharing personal information' — a consumer feature but an opacity risk for businesses with AML or sanctions-screening obligations.

### Fraud & SIM-Swap

Africa suffers ~$3–4B in annual cybercrime losses (INTERPOL 2025 Africa Cyberthreat Assessment). SIM-swap is a leading mobile-money attack vector — a hijacked SIM instantly redirects alias-based payments.

Mitigation: validate webhooks cryptographically; apply velocity and anomaly rules; for high-value RTP flows add an out-of-band confirmation. Irrevocability makes post-fraud recovery extremely difficult.

### Audit Trail & Irrevocability

PI-SPI holds a centralised audit log for every transaction — timestamps, aliases, amounts, participant codes — at BCEAO. Per stated BCEAO principles, confirmed payments are irrevocable; there is no chargeback mechanism.

Business benefit: ISO 20022's rich message data supports automated reconciliation and audit. Business risk: payment errors cannot be reversed — robust pre-authorisation validation and reconciliation controls are essential before go-live.

### AML / STR Obligations

Law No. 2016-992 (CI), amended 2023, mandates KYC, transaction monitoring, and STR filing with CENTIF-CI. Records must be retained ≥ 7 years after client relationship ends. Non-compliance risks fines or licence suspension.

ISO 20022 carries structured counterparty and transaction data, enabling automated AML screening. Pipe PI-SPI webhook data into your compliance engine and define clear STR escalation thresholds at onboarding.

### Operational & Systemic Risk

PI-SPI is a single centralised hub — a BCEAO outage cascades across all 70+ participants simultaneously. As of Jan 2026, only ~221,000 customers had registered a PI-SPI alias (The Africa Report), indicating early adoption stage.

Recommendation: maintain a fallback payment channel (e.g. direct bilateral EMI integration) for business continuity. Define SLA expectations with your participant bank/EMI and monitor BCEAO's published participant list.

**Sources:** BCEAO pispi.bceao.int (FAQ, À propos, Instruction 001-01-2024) · Law No. 2016-992 CI (amended 2023) · INTERPOL Africa Cyberthreat Assessment 2025 · The Africa Report, Jan 2026 · Financial Afrik Mar 2026 · voveid.com KYC Côte d'Ivoire 2026 Guide

# PI-SPI: Standard Access vs API Business

| | 🏦 Standard Access (via Your Bank) | ⚙️ API Business Integration |
|---|---|---|
| What it is | Use PI-SPI through your bank's existing app or portal — no technical setup. **To receive:** share your bank-generated QR code or alias with clients — they pay from any app. **To pay:** log into your bank portal and enter the recipient's alias. Manual, one transaction at a time. | Your participant bank issues API credentials. Your ERP/software connects to PI-SPI using those credentials and can: **push payments** to any alias programmatically, **send a Request-to-Pay** to a client's mobile wallet, and **receive webhooks** the moment funds land — no manual checking required. |
| Example | 📥 **Receipt:** A bakery client scans the mill's QR code and pays XOF 450,000 for a flour delivery. Credit appears in the mill's bank account in <10 seconds.<br>📤 **Payment:** Mill manager logs into bank app and manually transfers XOF 180,000 to a wheat farmer via PI-SPI alias. | 📥 **Receipt:** API sends a Request-to-Pay to distributor's mobile wallet on invoice generation. Webhook confirms payment; ERP auto-marks invoice settled.<br>📤 **Payment:** Mill's ERP triggers bulk farmer payouts at harvest — 50+ transfers initiated simultaneously, all reconciled automatically. |
| Best for | • Ad-hoc flour sales to walk-in clients<br>• One-off payments to local farmers/suppliers<br>• Low-volume operations or pilot stage<br>• No IT infrastructure available | • Recurring distributor & wholesaler invoicing<br>• Bulk farmer payments at harvest season<br>• ERP-integrated accounts payable/receivable<br>• Multi-country UEMOA sourcing & sales |

**Setup** None — use your bank app → Technical integration via participant bank API

**Cost** Standard bank fees only → Bank fees + possible API access fee

**Automation** Manual / semi-manual → Fully automated

# Why Payments Take 2–3 Days — The 7-Layer Gap

*Infrastructure speed ≠ customer experience. STAR/SICA can settle fast — but 7 processing layers sit between the system and the customer's account.*

### 1 Internal Bank Processing

**0–2 days**

Validate instruction · AML/KYC screening · Verify funds · Prepare SICA/STAR payment file

### 2 SICA Batch Cycle

**+0–1 day**

SICA runs ONE session per day. Missing the daily cut-off = next session

### 3 Receiving Bank Crediting

**+0–1 day**

After SICA settlement, receiving bank posts funds. Internal procedures may delay by hours to 1 day

### 4 Correspondent Banking

**+1–2 days**

Banks not directly in SICA/STAR route through a correspondent bank — adds steps and delays

### 5 Weekends, Holidays & Cut-offs

**+1–3 days**

Payment crossing a weekend/holiday or after cut-off waits to next business day — compounds

### 6 AML/KYC Holds

**+1–5 days**

Unusual amounts, new payees, or flagged transactions → manual compliance review

### 7 Pre-PI-SPI Interoperability Gap

**Eliminated for PI-SPI members**

Before Oct. 2025, no instant interoperable channel. PI-SPI (launched Sept. 30, 2025, 86 institutions) resolves Layers 1–3 for adopters: 24/7, irrevocable, under 10 seconds

⚠ Regulatory note: WAEMU has no PSD2-equivalent mandating customer-level transfer deadlines (unlike EU). No BCEAO instruction specifies maximum execution times at customer level. Contractual bank SLAs may apply. | Source: *bceao.int/en/content/sica-uemoa · Instruction 001-01-2024*

*Source: BCEAO SICA-UEMOA (bceao.int/en/content/sica-uemoa) · BCEAO Instruction 001-01-2024 · Invest-Time Oct. 2025*

# COMMERCIAL VISION

To enhance the value equation of nutrition in the communities we serve.

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Strategies** | DEFEND OUR FLOUR MARKET LEADERSHIP POSITION | GROW OUR COMPOUND FEEDS FOOTPRINT | FURTHER DEVELOP THE INTEGRATED HUMAN NUTRITION BUSINESS | GROW THE REGIONAL INTEGRATED PROTEIN BUSINESS | PURSUE TARGETED INORGANIC GROWTH OPPORTUNITIES |
| **Initiatives** | Invest in milling capacity | Invest in ruminant feed milling capacity | Invest in pasta production capacity | Invest in genetic footprints | Opportunistically leverage supply chain advantages to grow industrial footprint |
| | Enhance route to market and product range | Invest in poultry feed milling capacity | Invest in industrial bakery capacity and extend product range | Invest in integrated farrow to finish capacity | Evaluate operational portfolio |
| **Measures** | • #1 in national (commercial) market share | • 100% Byproduct optimization capability<br>• #1 in national (commercial) market share | • 25% national pasta market share<br>• 10% national bread market share | • 10% national pork market share | • 200k MT incremental sales volumes |

# Business Strategy Structure - GMA

## Project Pipeline

- Mill automation
- Feed mill Storage at port
- Packaging upgrades

Pasta Plant
$39M

Silos rehab II
$5.6M

Weighbridge 2
$600K

**Overview**
GMA was established in 1963, shortly after the independence of Ivory Coast. Since then, the great white tower silos overlooking the Ebrié lagoon have become one of the landmarks of Abidjan. Seaboardoverseas

**Ownership**
GMA was acquired by Seaboard Corporation in 2018 FW Africa, having previously been part of Groupe Mimran. It operates under Seaboard's Commodity Trading and Milling segment, managed through Seaboard Overseas and Trading Group (SOTG).

**Location & Physical Presence**
GMA has two milling plants located respectively at the ports of Abidjan and San Pedro in Ivory Coast. Digital Logistics Capacity Assessments Its registered address is Zone Portuaire, Quai n°1, Abidjan.

**Products**
GMA produces wheat flour, wheat bran, and animal feed. In recent years, GMA has made use of byproducts of flour manufacturing, such as wheat bran, turning it into animal feed designed to facilitate the development of the livestock sector in West Africa.

**Scale & Capacity**
GMA has a production capacity of 1,000 tons of wheat flour per day. Faraafrica The company has a turnover of more than 50 billion CFA francs (approximately US$78.8 million) and more than 250 employees. FW Africa In 2022, GMA invested US$15.7 million in six new cereal silos, increasing its total storage capacity to 50,000 tonnes of grain, enabling it to process 300,000 tonnes of cereals annually. FW Africa

**Market Position**
GMA's flour mill is one of the largest in the WAEMU (West African Economic and Monetary Union) region, with products marketed and sold in Ivory Coast, Burkina Faso, Mali, and Niger. LinkedIn

**Mission**
GMA's stated mission is to remain the largest flour-miller in the WAEMU region, provide quality products to customers, offer rewarding jobs to staff, and accompany the development of Côte d'Ivoire while developing synergies within the Seaboard group.

## Commercial Vision

Commodity Trading
- Procurement

Freight & Logistics
- Own Fleet & Charter

Industrial
- Flour / Feed Mills

Byproduct Optimization
- Feed Mills / Storage

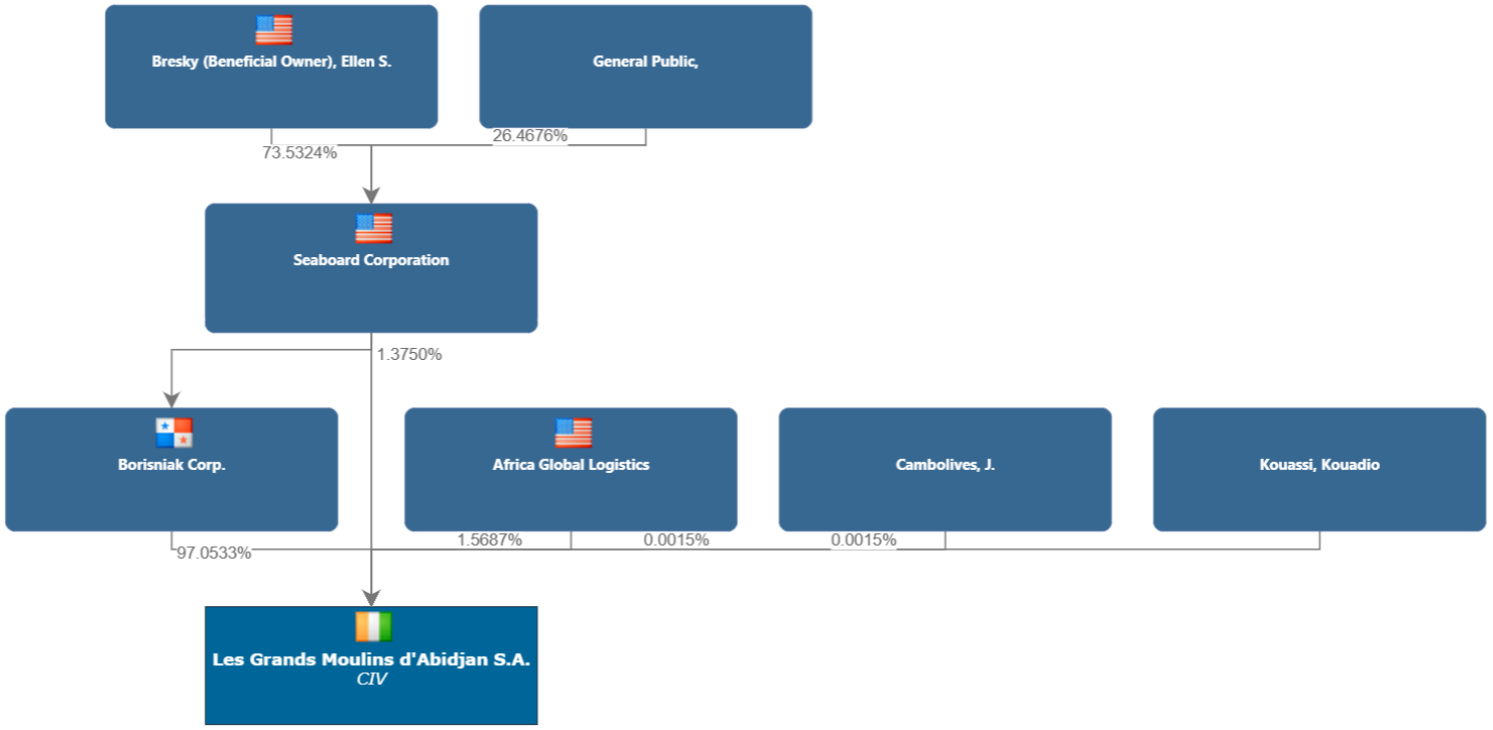
Value-Add & B2C
- Bread / Pasta

# Placeholder - Business Strategy Structure - GMA

**Depots:** GMA has over 17 depots that sell their products. These depots target street shops and B2B orders.

# Placeholder – Collections processes

# Legal Structure




Summary Page

| | |
|---|---|
| **Business Entity Details** | |
| Business Entity Name | Les Grands Moulins d'Abidjan S.A. |
| Legal Entity Type | Corporation |
| Jurisdiction | Ivory Coast |
| Abbreviation | GMA |
| Entity Status | Active |
| Division | Seaboard Overseas Division |
| % Votes Held By Top Corporation | 98.4282% |
| **Registration Details** | |
| Registered address | Zone Portuaire, Rue du Havre, Abidjan 01, Ivory Coast |
| Entity Registration Number | CI-ABJ-1963-B-2695 |
| Formation Date | 1962-12-27 |
| **Tax Details** | |
| Reference Number | FIV01Y |
| Employer Identification Number (EIN) | 98-1416036 |
| Foreign Tax ID | 5007123M |
| U.S. Tax Status | C Corporation |
| Election Made | Yes |
| Election Choice | Foreign Corporation |
| Effective Date of Election | 2024-11-29 |

**NOTE**

GMA is working on buying out the 3 non-seaboard shareholders.

# Côte d'Ivoire — Tax Overview: Wheat Milling Company

## KEY TAX RATES

**25%**
**Corporate Income Tax**
Min. tax: 0.5% of turnover

**18%**
**VAT (standard rate)**
Exports zero-rated; 9% on durum pasta, 18% on soft pasta (Pativoire)

**15%**
**Dividend WHT (IRVM)**
10% if listed; 95% parent co. exemption

**18%**
**Interco Interest WHT (IRC)**
9% for equipment loans ≥3 yrs

**10%**
**Tax on Banking Ops (TOB)**
Charged by banks; deductible vs. VAT

**0%**
**VAT on Flour**
Flour is tax exempt

**9%**
**VAT on Feed**
9% applies to hard wheat/durum pasta as well

## IMPORT & OPERATING TAXES

- **Wheat grain import (ECOWAS CET): 5%**
- + Statistical duty 1% + AU levy 0.2% + Community levies 1.3%
- VAT on import: 18% of (CIF + duties)
- Business franchise tax (Patente): 0.5% of turnover + 18.5% on rental value
- Special equipment tax: 0.1% of turnover (all companies)
- Real estate tax (TFF): 11–15% on property value

## PAYROLL & SOCIAL CHARGES

- **ITS income tax: progressive 0–60% (merged 2024)**
- Employer surcharge: 2.8% (local) / 12% (expatriates)
- CNPS pension: 7.7% employer + 6.3% employee
- Family allowances: 5.75% | Work injury: 2–5%
- CNPS pension cap: XOF 3,375,000 / month
- Family & injury caps: XOF 70,000 / month

## KEY TAX DEDUCTIONS

- All documented operating costs (wheat, utilities, staff, maintenance)
- Depreciation: straight-line — buildings 5%/yr; new machinery 2× in yr 1
- Interest: deductible up to 30% of EBITDA
- Intra-group fees to foreign parent: capped at 5% of turnover & 20% of overhead
- Operating losses: 5-yr carryforward; depreciation losses: indefinite carryforward
- Most taxes deductible (except CIT & withholding taxes)

## INVESTMENT INCENTIVES (AGRO-INDUSTRY – CATEGORY 1)

- **Wheat milling = agro-industrial Category 1 → eligible for Investment Code exemptions**
- Declaration Regime: CIT, patente, TFF, payroll & IRVM exemptions for 5–15 years (no min. investment)
- Approval Regime (min. XOF 200m): 100% exemption for 5 yrs, then 50% for 5 yrs
- 35–40% of fixed asset investment deductible from taxable income with DGI prior approval

## OPEN QUESTIONS

- What is the exact VAT classification of imported raw wheat grain in 2025–26 post-2026 Tax Annex?
- What zone (A/B/C) applies to our location? What is the Investment Code approval process & timeline?
- Is the 18% IRC on interco interest a final WHT or can it be credited against the recipient's CIT?
- What is the environmental classification of a flour mill & the annual 2024 environmental fee amount?
- Are there any other structures better suited for the tax environment?

# Methods to Repatriate Cash – Current State

## COMMODITY PREPAYMENTS

**Lowest cost for the company – Maximize this option**

Cost: 0.71%

- Central bank: 0.60%
- Local bank: 0.10%
- VAT on 0.10%: 0.01%
- FX Rate

Restrictions:

- Maximum prepayment level is 6 months with a 3-month grace period. Invoices cannot be prepaid for a ship that will arrive in 9 months.
- Invoices can only be prepaid 50% (used to be 80%)

Process:

- GMA requests and receives invoice
- GMA prepares documentation, requesting their DPI (customs document) and submits the payment to the bank of choice
- The bank reviews the documentation. If all is correct, they will group with their other requests from other customers and send to the central bank for the FX.
- Central bank reviews and approves batch. Bank receives their FX and makes payment to Eurafrique.

Note: If any payments in the submitted batch are incorrect, the entire batch gets rejected by the central bank. When liquidity is tight, the central bank will find more reasons to reject payment batches.

Remaining 50% of payment can be paid once the ship arrives in Ivory Coast.

## FX CAPEX PREPAYMENT

**Lowest cost for the company**

Cost: 0.71%

- Central bank: 0.60%
- Local bank: 0.10%
- VAT on 0.10%: 0.01%
- FX Rate

Restrictions:

- Invoices can only be prepaid 50%

Process:

- GMA requests and receives invoice from Brandy
- GMA prepares documentation and submits the payment to the bank of choice. Documentation will likely need the underlying equipment contract included.
- The bank reviews the documentation. If all is correct, they will group with their other requests from other customers and send to the central bank for the FX.
- Central bank reviews and approves batch. Bank receives their FX and makes payment to SOG.

Remaining 50% of payment can be paid once the equipment arrives in Ivory Coast.

## INTERCOMPANY LOAN

**Slight tax friction (2-3%) per annum – depends on amount and entities borrowing.**

Process:

- Lending entity prepares agreement
- Lending board authorizes the IC loan
- Lending entity sends a declaration to the Ministry of Finance, they will send an acknowledgement
- Lending entity sends a check for the registration fee of the contact and to the Debt Collections Office
- Lending entity sends funds to borrowers
- When paying back loan, borrowing entity will send the payment back with interest.

This is a good option for when one entity in the WEAMU region has excess cash, and another has capacity to get money out.

The tax friction comes from the non-deductible tax on interest income.

Calculation: the principal balance of the loan, subtracting the lending company's capital, multiplied by the interest rate, multiplied by tax rate.

Transfer pricing concerns if outstanding for too long.

## DIVIDEND PAYMENT

**Most Expensive – Permanent Cost (15% WHT)**

Process:

- Determine dividend size and obtain internal and board approvals
- General Assembly meeting takes place
- Documentation submitted to local bank for review
- WHT payment completed
- Bank submits documentation to central bank, central bank reviews and approves
- Payment is sent to SOL

GMA has one opportunity a year to declare a dividend. Payment must be completed by September 30th each year, with strict deadlines along the way.

## ADDITIONAL COMMENTS

Depending on market liquidity and our banking relationship, in some circumstances during prepayments the banks will prefinance our payment to speed up processing times. This means that when they submit the documentation to the central bank, at the same time they will use their own FX reserves and make the payment abroad on our behalf. When the central bank provides the FX back to the bank, it will replenish this reserve. We have a fast-track program with Societe Generale (undocumented) that allows our payments to be prioritized by them. BOA also lets us do it more frequently than others, CITI has started prefinancing for us. SIB and Atlantique can normally fast track the central bank approval process due to their internal processing efficiency, therefor almost never need to prefinance.

Extract from instruction (BCEAO Instruction No. 02.07.2025 RFE, Article 6, Paragraph f):

*if it concerns the payment of an advance/deposit, the importer must produce a certified true copy of the invoice or commercial contract indicating the requirement for said advance payment, which may not exceed 50% of the value of the goods or services.*

This regulation has been in effect since August 1, 2025 across the monetary region. There was an adjustment period until January 2026 where no further exceptions will be permitted and full compliance is mandatory.

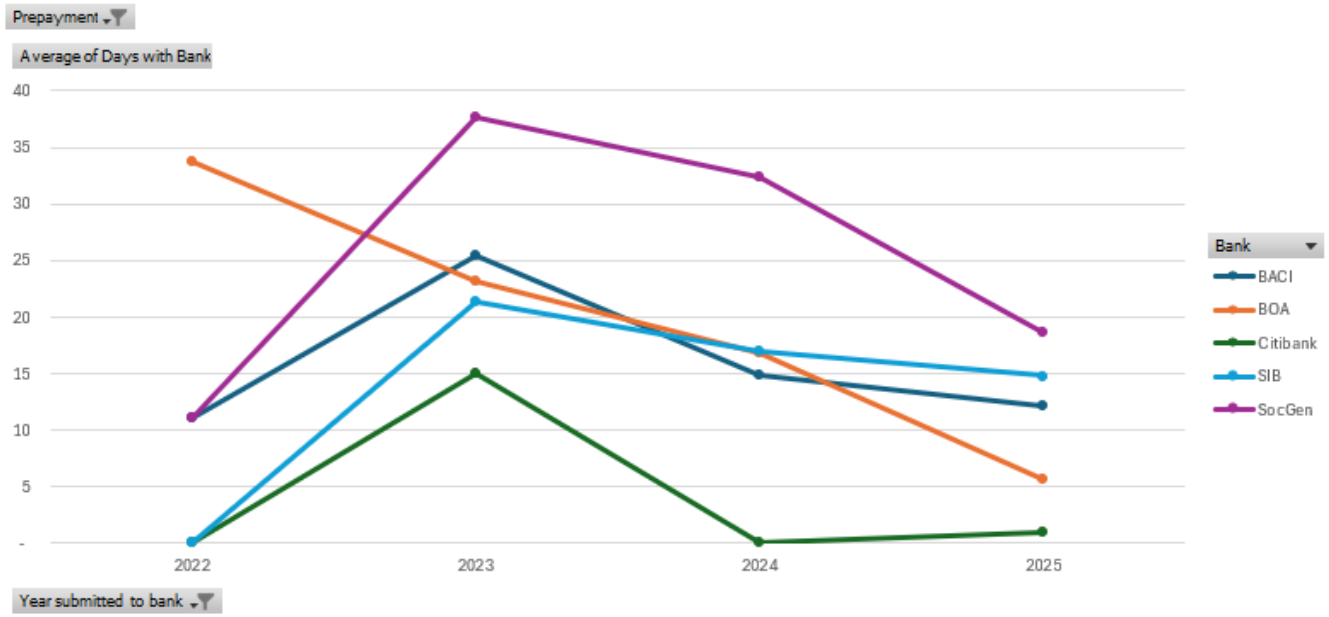
Link : https://www.bceao.int/fr/reglementations/instruction-ndeg-02-07-2025-rfe-relative-la-domiciliation-et-au-reglement-des

# Wheat Prepayments

## Number of Invoices by Bank and Year

| Count of Invoice | Column Labels | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Row Labels | 2022 | 2023 | 2024 | 2025 | Grand Total |
| BACI | 1 | 7 | 9 | 5 | 22 |
| BOA | 5 | 11 | 12 | 7 | 35 |
| Citibank | | 2 | | 4 | 6 |
| SIB | | 12 | 14 | 13 | 39 |
| SocGen | 3 | 10 | 12 | 9 | 34 |
| **Grand Total** | **9** | **42** | **47** | **38** | **136** |

## Average Days with the Bank by Bank and Year




## ADDITIONAL COMMENTS

CITI is showing as lower on the average days with bank as we had only done 2 prepayment transactions with them prior to 2025. In 2025 we negotiated prefinancing with the team so this will show as quicker than the other banks.

Socgen has put us on their fast track program in 2025. This should increase processing times.

| Row Labels | Column Labels 2022 Average of Days with Bank | 2022 Max of Days with Bank | 2023 Average of Days with Bank | 2023 Max of Days with Bank | 2024 Average of Days with Bank | 2024 Max of Days with Bank | 2025 Average of Days with Bank | 2025 Max of Days with Bank | Total Average of Days with Bank | Total Max of Days with Bank |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| BACI | 11 | 11 | 25 | 37 | 15 | 33 | 12 | 15 | 17 | 37 |
| BOA | 68 | 125 | 23 | 42 | 17 | 34 | 6 | 11 | 20 | 125 |
| Citibank | | | 15 | 15 | | | 1 | 1 | 6 | 15 |
| SIB | | | 21 | 36 | 17 | 29 | 15 | 35 | 18 | 36 |
| SocGen | 16 | 16 | 38 | 87 | 32 | 69 | 19 | 37 | 30 | 87 |
| **Grand Total** | **41** | **125** | **26** | **87** | **20** | **69** | **12** | **37** | **20** | **125** |

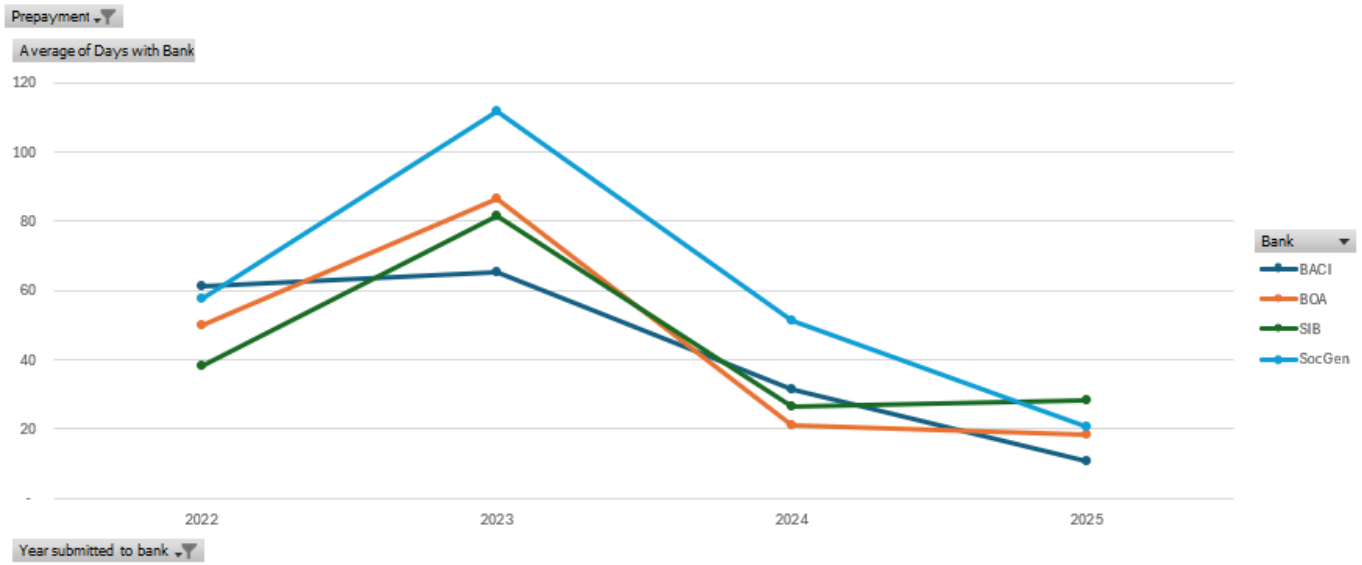
Source: GMA Daily Cash file

# Wheat Remaining Payments

**Number of Invoices by Bank and Year**

| Count of Invoice | Column Labels | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Row Labels | 2022 | 2023 | 2024 | 2025 | Grand Total |
| BACI | 4 | 2 | 2 | 11 | 19 |
| BOA | 16 | 10 | 5 | 19 | 50 |
| SIB | 5 | 7 | 9 | 13 | 34 |
| SocGen | 15 | 12 | 5 | 11 | 43 |
| **Grand Total** | **40** | **31** | **21** | **54** | **146** |

**Average Days with the Bank by Bank and Year**



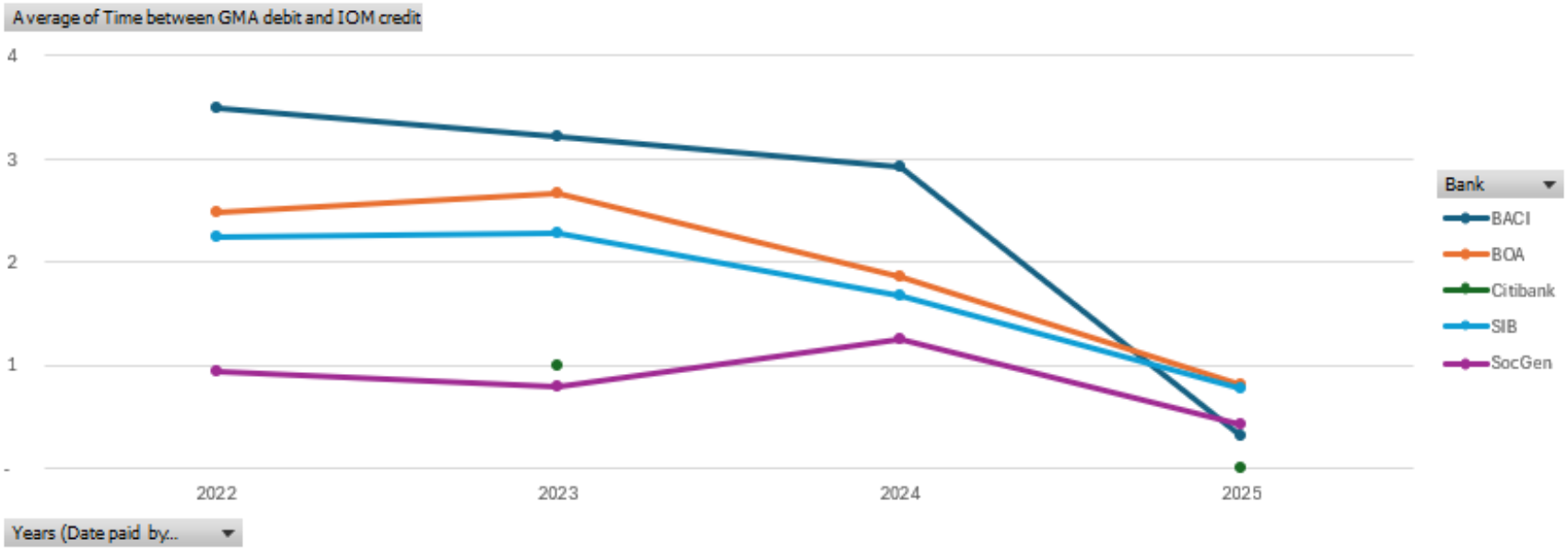

| | Column Labels | | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | 2022 | | 2023 | | 2024 | | 2025 | | Total Average of Days with Bank | Total Max of Days with Bank |
| Row Labels | Average of Days with Bank | Max of Days with Bank | Average of Days with Bank | Max of Days with Bank | Average of Days with Bank | Max of Days with Bank | Average of Days with Bank | Max of Days with Bank | | |
| BACI | 61 | 105 | 66 | 109 | 32 | 35 | 11 | 14 | 29 | 109 |
| BOA | 50 | 205 | 86 | 215 | 21 | 43 | 18 | 117 | 42 | 215 |
| SIB | 38 | 84 | 82 | 217 | 26 | 51 | 28 | 117 | 40 | 217 |
| SocGen | 57 | 152 | 112 | 317 | 51 | 93 | 21 | 30 | 62 | 317 |
| **Grand Total** | **52** | **205** | **94** | **317** | **31** | **93** | **20** | **117** | **46** | **317** |

Source: GMA Daily Cash file

# Eurafrique Receipt Times

| Row Labels | Column Labels: 2022 – Average of Time between GMA debit and IOM credit | 2022 – Max of Time between GMA debit and IOM credit | 2023 – Average of Time between GMA debit and IOM credit | 2023 – Max of Time between GMA debit and IOM credit | 2024 – Average of Time between GMA debit and IOM credit | 2024 – Max of Time between GMA debit and IOM credit | 2025 – Average of Time between GMA debit and IOM credit | 2025 – Max of Time between GMA debit and IOM credit | Total Average of Time between GMA debit and IOM credit | Total Max of Time between GMA debit and IOM credit |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| BACI | 4 | 10 | 3 | 14 | 3 | 11 | 0 | 3 | 2 | 14 |
| BOA | 2 | 14 | 3 | 9 | 2 | 6 | 1 | 8 | 2 | 14 |
| Citibank | | | 1 | 1 | | | - | - | 0 | 1 |
| SIB | 2 | 4 | 2 | 7 | 2 | 3 | 1 | 4 | 2 | 7 |
| SocGen | 1 | 2 | 1 | 2 | 1 | 13 | 0 | 3 | 1 | 13 |
| **Grand Total** | **2** | **14** | **2** | **14** | **2** | **13** | **1** | **8** | **1** | **14** |

**Average Days between GMA debit and IOM credit by Bank by Year**




Source: GMA Daily Cash file

# Technology: Applications / Systems – Current State

**BANKING**

CitiDIRECT

SOCIETE GENERALE

Société Ivoirienne de Banque
Groupe Attijariwafa bank

BANQUE ATLANTIQUE

BANK OF AFRICA
BMCE GROUP

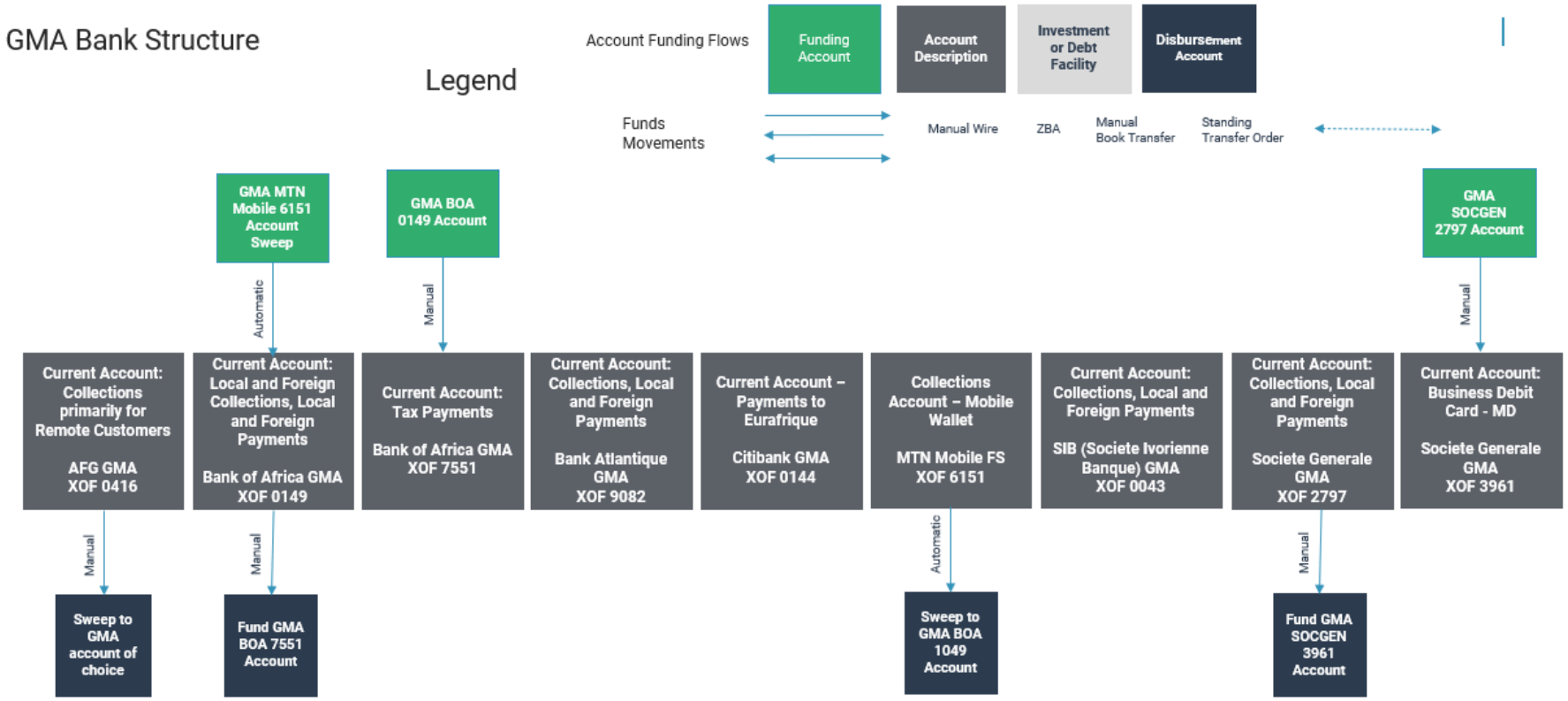
MTN Mobile Money

NOTE: AFG does not have online banking abilities yet. They are in the process of developing it for their customers.

**ACCOUNTING**

Microsoft Dynamics 365
Business Central

# Accounts & Flows




| Account | Account Type | MT940 Status | Reporting | Reporting Frequency | MT940 Weekend Reporting? | Transaction Value Dates |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| AFG XOF 0416 | Current Account (CA) | MT940 Not Available | Manual | Daily: Monday to Friday | No | Monday to Friday |
| BATL XOF 9082 | Current Account (CA) | MT940 Active | INFOPOOL (Citibank) | Daily: Monday through Sunday | Sometimes | Monday through Sunday |
| BOA XOF 1049 | CA only reports w Act | MT940 Active | INFOPOOL (Citibank) | Daily: Monday to Friday | No | Monday through Sunday |
| BOA XOF 7551 | CA only reports w Act | MT940 Active | INFOPOOL (Citibank) | Daily: Monday to Friday | No | Monday through Sunday |
| CITI XOF 0144 | Current Account (CA) | MT940 Active | BAI (Citibank) | Daily: Monday to Friday | No | Monday through Sunday |
| MTN XOF 6151 | WA Collections Only | MT940 Not Available | Not reporting | Not reporting in 2025 | No | Monday through Sunday (in 2024) |
| SIB XOF 0043 | CA with Overdraft | MT940 Active | INFOPOOL (Citibank) | Daily: Monday to Friday | No | Monday through Sunday |
| SOCGEN XOF 2797 | CA with Overdraft | MT940 Active | INFOPOOL (Citibank) | Daily: Monday to Friday | No | Monday through Sunday |
| SOCGEN XOF 3961 | Current Account (CA) | MT940 Active | INFOPOOL (Citibank) | Daily: Monday to Friday | No | Monday through Sunday |

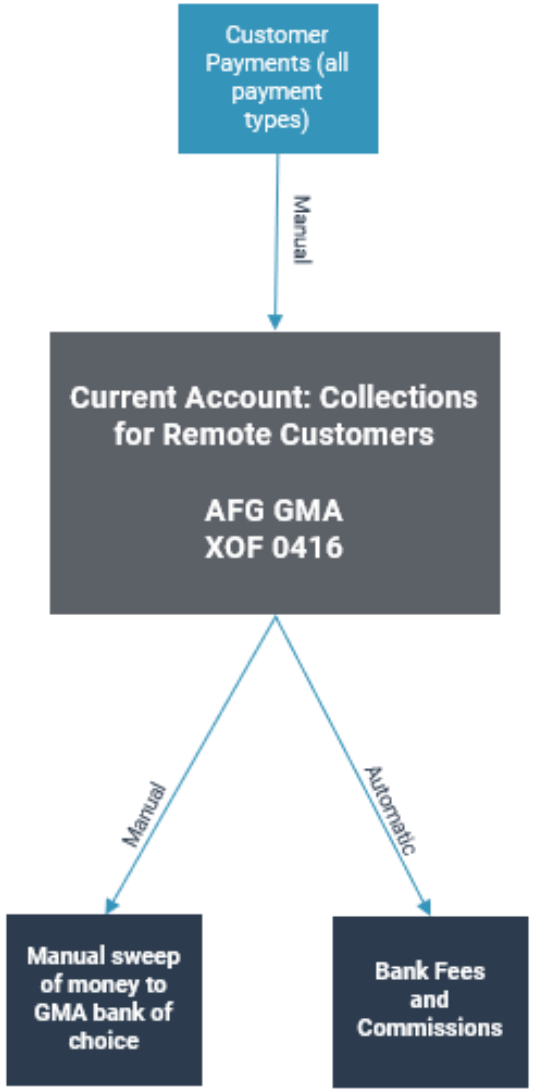
**NOTES**

Historically, the main GMA accounts (BOA 0149, BACI 9082, CITI 0144, SIB 0043, SOCGEN 2797) have all made wheat payments to Eurafrique and fund each other to make the payments. The way a bank is chosen to make this payment is based on a bank's available liquidity. GMA tries to give a spread prepayments over the bank in such a way not to have high amounts coming out of one bank. Also, the fastest banks are prioritized during the period.

In the current state, funds are being transferred to CITI to limit counterparty exposure.

We are working on establishing the CIO product in the CITI account.

# Bank Account Diagram – AFG XOF 0416




***Account Transaction Activity (Type and Volume) – 01/01/2025 to 12/31/2025:***

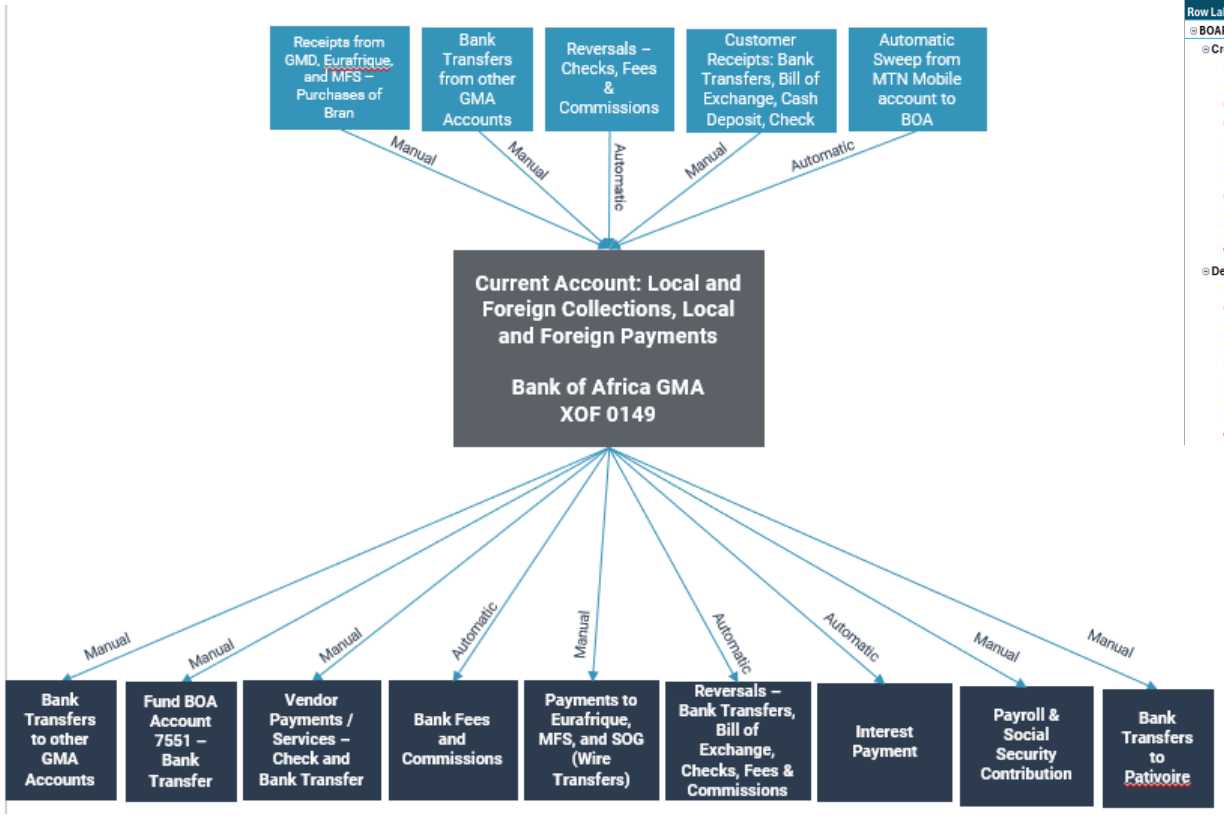
| Bank | AFG BK | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | Column Labels | | |
| | 2025 | | |
| Row Labels | Transaction Amount (LCY) | Transaction Amount (USD) | # of Transactions |
| **AFGGMAXOF0416** | **(226,415,996.00)** | **(404,314.28)** | **1740** |
| **Credit** | **5,315,971,931.00** | **9,492,807.02** | **758** |
| OTHER | 5,315,971,831.00 | 9,492,806.84 | 757 |
| FEES & COMMISSIONS | 100.00 | 0.18 | 1 |
| **Debit** | **(5,542,387,927.00)** | **(9,897,121.30)** | **982** |
| BANK TRANSFER | (5,541,557,700.00) | (9,895,638.75) | 96 |
| FEES & COMMISSIONS | (830,227.00) | (1,482.55) | 886 |
| **Grand Total** | **(226,415,996.00)** | **(404,314.28)** | **1740** |

**NOTES**

- AFG is in all of the post offices and therefor available to more remote customers – they have an office connected to the post office with the clerk etc. at every post office (share the same building)
- AFG acquired Banque Populare (used to be a government bank, no longer is) - they do not have an online platform yet, it is being developed.
- They think this would be a tough one to get rid of due to the remote presence. Cyril is working with his commercial team to get numbers on how many people are remote.

# Bank Account Diagram – BOA XOF 0149

***Account.Transaction.Activity.(Type.and.Volume).-.67-67-8680..to.78-97-8680***

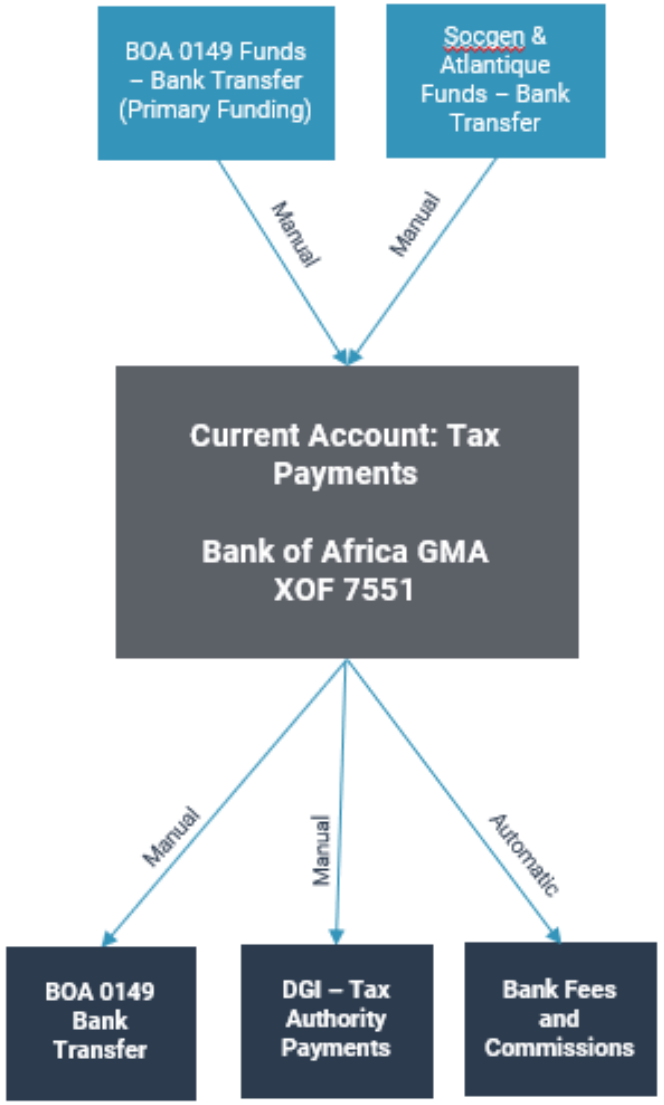



| Row Labels | 2024 Transaction Amount (LCY) | 2024 Transaction Amount (USD) | 2024 # of Transactions | 2025 Transaction Amount (LCY) | 2025 Transaction Amount (USD) | 2025 # of Transactions |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **BOAFRICAGMA0149** | **(1,357,153,957.00)** | **(2,423,489.21)** | **7314** | **250,026,202.48** | **446,475.36** | **6255** |
| **Credit** | **53,773,884,143.00** | **96,024,793.11** | **3737** | **39,697,464,987.00** | **70,888,330.33** | **3868** |
| BANK TRANSFER | 8,870,562,534.00 | 15,840,290.24 | 308 | 4,064,927,352.00 | 7,258,798.84 | 378 |
| BILL OF EXCHANGE | 17,399,816,952.00 | 31,071,101.70 | 1516 | 13,438,983,277.00 | 23,998,184.42 | 1652 |
| CASH DEPOSIT | 7,485,742,265.00 | 13,367,396.90 | 770 | 7,917,936,915.00 | 14,139,173.06 | 948 |
| CHECK | 15,742,631,545.00 | 28,111,842.04 | 978 | 6,645,506,522.00 | 11,866,975.93 | 727 |
| FEES & COMMISSIONS | | | | 3,190.00 | 5.70 | 1 |
| INTEREST INCOME | 9,567,992.00 | 17,085.70 | 12 | 8,022,351.00 | 14,325.63 | 10 |
| MOBILE WALLET | 2,954,508,275.00 | 5,275,907.63 | 94 | 5,370,368,700.00 | 9,589,944.11 | 134 |
| OTHER | | | | 74,644,353.00 | 133,293.49 | 1 |
| REVERSAL - CHECK | 175,803,077.00 | 313,934.07 | 22 | 2,627,993.00 | 4,692.84 | 5 |
| REVERSAL - FEES & COMMISSIONS | 215,471.00 | 384.77 | 31 | 31,350.00 | 55.98 | 5 |
| WIRE TRANSFER | 1,135,036,032.00 | 2,026,850.06 | 6 | 2,174,412,984.00 | 3,882,880.33 | 7 |
| **Debit** | **(55,131,038,100.00)** | **(98,448,282.32)** | **3577** | **(39,447,438,784.52)** | **(70,441,854.97)** | **2387** |
| BANK TRANSFER | (24,315,361,156.00) | (43,420,287.78) | 1462 | (18,704,887,431.00) | (33,401,584.70) | 803 |
| CHECK | (7,319,041,981.00) | (13,069,717.82) | 681 | (4,231,285,702.96) | (7,555,867.33) | 361 |
| FEES & COMMISSIONS | (87,943,705.00) | (157,042.33) | 1129 | (76,644,427.56) | (136,865.05) | 1058 |
| INTEREST | (3,998,902.00) | (7,140.90) | 4 | (523,528.00) | (934.87) | 3 |
| REVERSAL - BANK TRANSFER | (83,643,849.00) | (149,364.02) | 1 | | | |
| REVERSAL - BILL OF EXCHANGE | (2,474,600,418.00) | (4,418,929.32) | 115 | (190,915,660.00) | (340,920.82) | 17 |
| REVERSAL - CHECK | (1,691,040,294.00) | (3,019,714.81) | 90 | (763,507,568.00) | (1,363,406.37) | 69 |
| REVERSAL - FEES & COMMISSIONS | (1,029,600.00) | (1,838.57) | 66 | (532,400.00) | (950.71) | 48 |
| WIRE TRANSFER | (19,154,378,195.00) | (34,204,246.78) | 29 | (15,479,142,067.00) | (27,641,325.12) | 28 |

## NOTES

- Rarely making vendor payments out of BOA in 2025 – moved to Socgen
- BOA was renumerating our current account in 2024 and 2025 at roughly 2% (above a certain amount of currency held in the account) – Cyril checking if this is still taking place, what the threshold amount is, and %.
- If people can't use AFG to pay GMA, they tend to use BOA for some reason.
- Additionally, for some reason this account has never had funds frozen before (this has happened in SIB, CITI, Atlantique, and Socgen)

# Bank Account Diagram – BOA XOF 7551



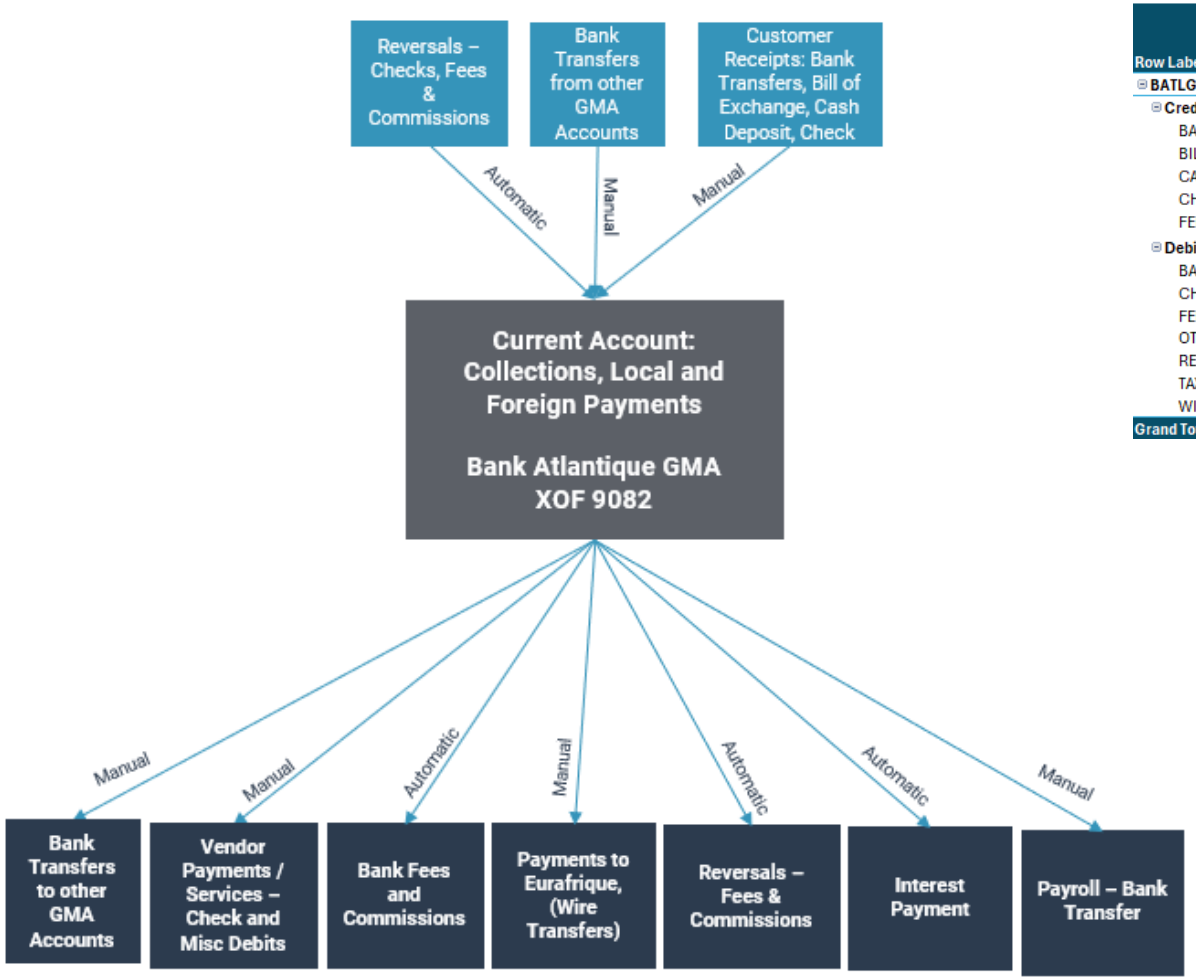

***Account Transaction Activity (Type and Volume) – 01/01/2024 to 12/31/2025:***

| Row Labels | Column Labels 2024 Transaction Amount (LCY) | Transaction Amount (USD) | # of Transactions | 2025 Transaction Amount (LCY) | Transaction Amount (USD) | # of Transactions |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **BOAFRICAGMA7551** | **(32,005,374.64)** | **(57,152.45)** | **158** | **4,761,587.00** | **8,502.83** | **298** |
| **Credit** | **6,979,439,572.00** | **12,463,284.95** | **25** | **5,130,000,000.00** | **9,160,714.29** | **20** |
| BANK TRANSFER | 6,940,000,000.00 | 12,392,857.14 | 23 | 5,130,000,000.00 | 9,160,714.29 | 20 |
| OTHER | 39,412,072.00 | 70,378.70 | 1 | | | |
| REVERSAL - FEES & COMMISSIONS | 27,500.00 | 49.11 | 1 | | | |
| **Debit** | **(7,011,444,946.64)** | **(12,520,437.40)** | **133** | **(5,125,238,413.00)** | **(9,152,211.45)** | **278** |
| BANK TRANSFER | (213,385,715.00) | (381,045.92) | 4 | (199,179,040.00) | (355,676.86) | 9 |
| FEES & COMMISSIONS | (3,901,977.64) | (6,967.82) | 47 | (2,379,623.00) | (4,249.33) | 40 |
| INTEREST | (8,449,956.00) | (15,089.21) | 7 | (1,264,299.00) | (2,257.68) | 6 |
| OTHER | (39,412,072.00) | (70,378.70) | 1 | | | |
| TAX | (6,746,295,226.00) | (12,046,955.76) | 74 | (4,922,415,451.00) | (8,790,027.59) | 223 |

**NOTES**

- There were a handful of vendor payments and services paid out of this account in December 2024 and April 2025 (9 total) – this is not an ongoing transaction. Did not include in the diagram, the payments were accidents.
- This is a sub account of the main BOA account (they are linked)
- This account's purpose is to mitigate risk. To pay taxes, you register your account on the tax authority's platform. The government technically has the ability to go and take money out of the account. We keep the balance of this account close to 0 and fund the account when there is a tax payment to be made. There's not been a situation before where an unjustified amount has been debited from the account, but it is kept separate just in case. To pay their taxes, they complete their declaration, file it, and then based on what is filed make the payment.

# Bank Account Diagram – Banque Atlantique XOF 9082



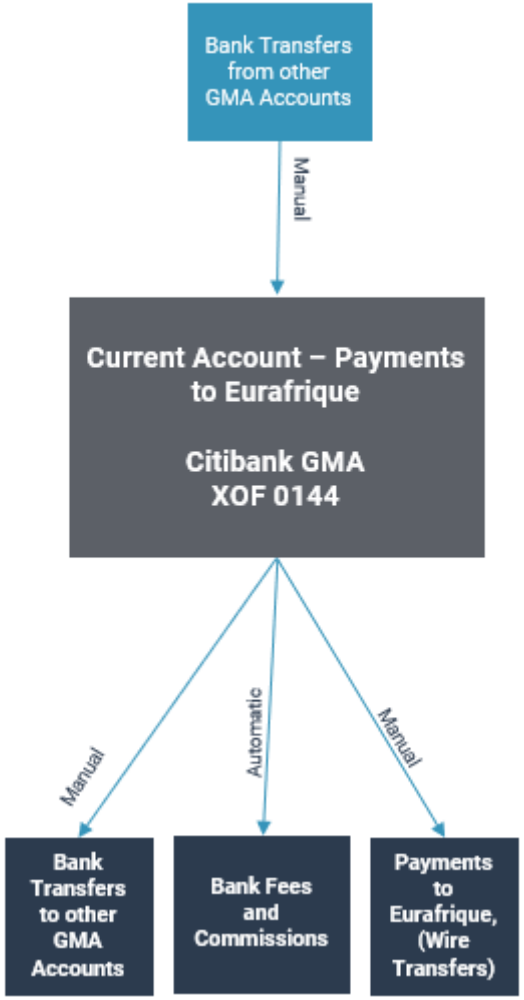

***Account.Transaction.Activity.(Type.and.Volume).-.67–67–8680..to.78–97–8680***

| Row Labels | Column Labels 2024 Transaction Amount (LCY) | 2024 Transaction Amount (USD) | 2024 # of Transactions | 2025 Transaction Amount (LCY) | 2025 Transaction Amount (USD) | 2025 # of Transactions |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **BATLGMAXOF9082** | **(826,208,970.03)** | **(1,475,373.16)** | **2104** | **293,742,674.06** | **524,540.49** | **3950** |
| **Credit** | **16,993,075,859.00** | **30,344,778.32** | **1504** | **25,945,399,489.06** | **46,331,070.52** | **3102** |
| BANK TRANSFER | 5,401,283,929.00 | 9,645,149.87 | 199 | 2,592,973,438.00 | 4,630,309.71 | 159 |
| BILL OF EXCHANGE | 4,247,846,050.00 | 7,585,439.38 | 360 | 6,103,881,936.00 | 10,899,789.17 | 646 |
| CASH DEPOSIT | 6,659,036,191.00 | 11,891,136.06 | 898 | 17,134,330,687.00 | 30,597,019.08 | 2286 |
| CHECK | 684,843,689.00 | 1,222,935.16 | 41 | 114,180,426.00 | 203,893.62 | 2 |
| FEES & COMMISSIONS | 66,000.00 | 117.86 | 6 | 33,001.56 | 58.93 | 7 |
| **Debit** | **(17,819,284,829.03)** | **(31,820,151.48)** | **600** | **(25,651,656,815.00)** | **(45,806,530.03)** | **848** |
| BANK TRANSFER | (7,741,499,457.00) | (13,824,106.17) | 76 | (13,928,465,237.00) | (24,872,259.35) | 127 |
| CHECK | (8,800.00) | (15.71) | 1 | (110,605,426.00) | (197,509.69) | 1 |
| FEES & COMMISSIONS | (6,557,173.78) | (11,709.24) | 447 | (9,522,697.00) | (17,004.82) | 678 |
| OTHER | (175,609,550.00) | (313,588.48) | 11 | (14,308,000.00) | (25,550.00) | 7 |
| REVERSAL - FEES & COMMISSIONS | (572,000.00) | (1,021.43) | 52 | (110,000.00) | (196.43) | 10 |
| TAX | (3,000.00) | (5.36) | 2 | (13,500.00) | (24.11) | 9 |
| WIRE TRANSFER | (9,895,034,848.00) | (17,669,705.09) | 10 | (11,588,631,955.00) | (20,693,985.63) | 16 |
| **Grand Total** | **(826,208,970.03)** | **(1,475,373.16)** | **2104** | **293,742,674.06** | **524,540.49** | **3950** |

**NOTES**

- Bank was renumerating our account for small amounts in 2024.

# Bank Account Diagram – Citibank XOF 0144



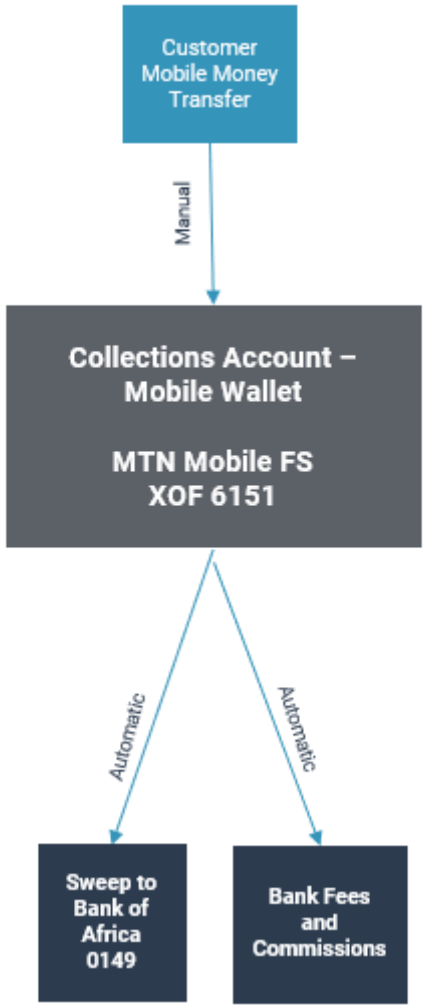

***Account Transaction Activity (Type and Volume) – 01/01/2024 to 12/31/2025:***

| Row Labels | Column Labels 2024 Transaction Amount (LCY) | 2024 Transaction Amount (USD) | 2024 # of Transactions | 2025 Transaction Amount (LCY) | 2025 Transaction Amount (USD) | 2025 # of Transactions |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **CITIGMAXOF0144** | **(110,000.00)** | **(196.43)** | **10** | **702,822,316.63** | **1,255,039.85** | **40** |
| **Credit** | | | | **6,407,293,391.00** | **11,441,595.34** | **4** |
| BANK TRANSFER | | | | 5,700,000,000.00 | 10,178,571.43 | 1 |
| OTHER | | | | 7,293,391.00 | 13,023.91 | 1 |
| WIRE TRANSFER | | | | 700,000,000.00 | 1,250,000.00 | 2 |
| **Debit** | **(110,000.00)** | **(196.43)** | **10** | **(5,704,471,074.37)** | **(10,186,555.49)** | **36** |
| BANK TRANSFER | | | | (2,375,000,000.00) | (4,241,071.43) | 1 |
| FEES & COMMISSIONS | (110,000.00) | (196.43) | 10 | (22,991,724.00) | (41,056.65) | 27 |
| INTEREST | | | | (3.37) | (0.01) | 2 |
| OTHER | | | | (7,293,391.00) | (13,023.91) | 1 |
| WIRE TRANSFER | | | | (3,299,185,956.00) | (5,891,403.49) | 5 |
| **Grand Total** | **(110,000.00)** | **(196.43)** | **10** | **702,822,316.63** | **1,255,039.85** | **40** |

**NOTES**

- CITI was not a primary relationship of GMA until the end of 2025 – low volume
- In the current state, all excess funds are being swept to CITI.
- Working to establish CIO product
- Would be difficult in the current state to route collections here due to the lack of retail presence.
- It would not be an issue to transition payments from Socgen to CITI – however, CITI is the most expensive of all of the banks. To get access to the pricing we do on the prepayments at each of the banks, we've promised some of our flows going through them for the wheat vessels – would need to sort this out if we no longer see ourselves doing it at a bank other then CITI.
- We have not seen CITI honor our prepayment pricing when liquidity is tight.
- Easiest banking platform to use (in Cyril's opinion)

# Bank Account Diagram – MTN Mobile XOF 6151



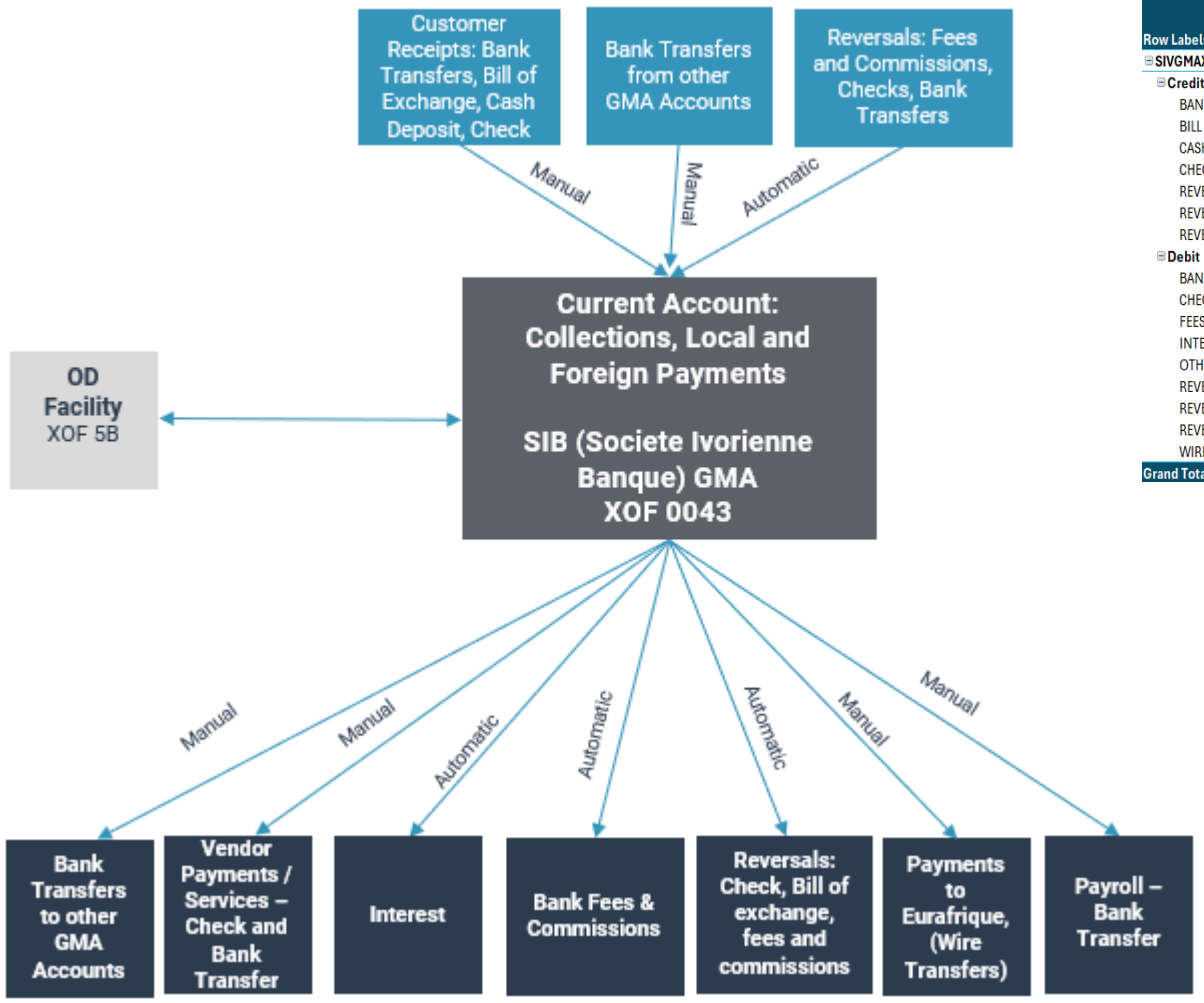

***Account.Transaction.Activity.(Type.and.Volume).- .67–67–8680..to.Nov.8680¿***

| Row Labels | Column Labels 2024 Transaction Amount (LCY) | Transaction Amount (USD) | # of Transactions |
|---|---|---|---|
| **MTNGMAXOF6151** | **(55,711,726.00)** | **(99,485.22)** | **4691** |
| **Credit** | **3,711,987,164.00** | **6,628,548.51** | **2711** |
| MOBILE WALLET | 3,711,987,164.00 | 6,628,548.51 | 2711 |
| **Debit** | **(3,767,698,890.00)** | **(6,728,033.73)** | **1980** |
| BANK TRANSFER | (3,767,511,190.00) | (6,727,698.55) | 103 |
| FEES & COMMISSIONS | (187,700.00) | (335.18) | 1877 |
| **Grand Total** | **(55,711,726.00)** | **(99,485.22)** | **4691** |

**NOTES**

- This account stopped reporting manually in November 2024.
- Thinking that this account will be closed and hopefully replaced by Orange or Wave. MTN only has 20% of the market share for mobile money in Cote d'Ivoire – wave has the largest (around 50%) and they are an American company. Cyril needs to do an audit.
- Sweep is one bulk transaction (RTGS if over XOF 50M)
- Working with Cyril to understand how long funds take to clear and show up in the BOA account.

# Bank Account Diagram – SIB XOF 0043



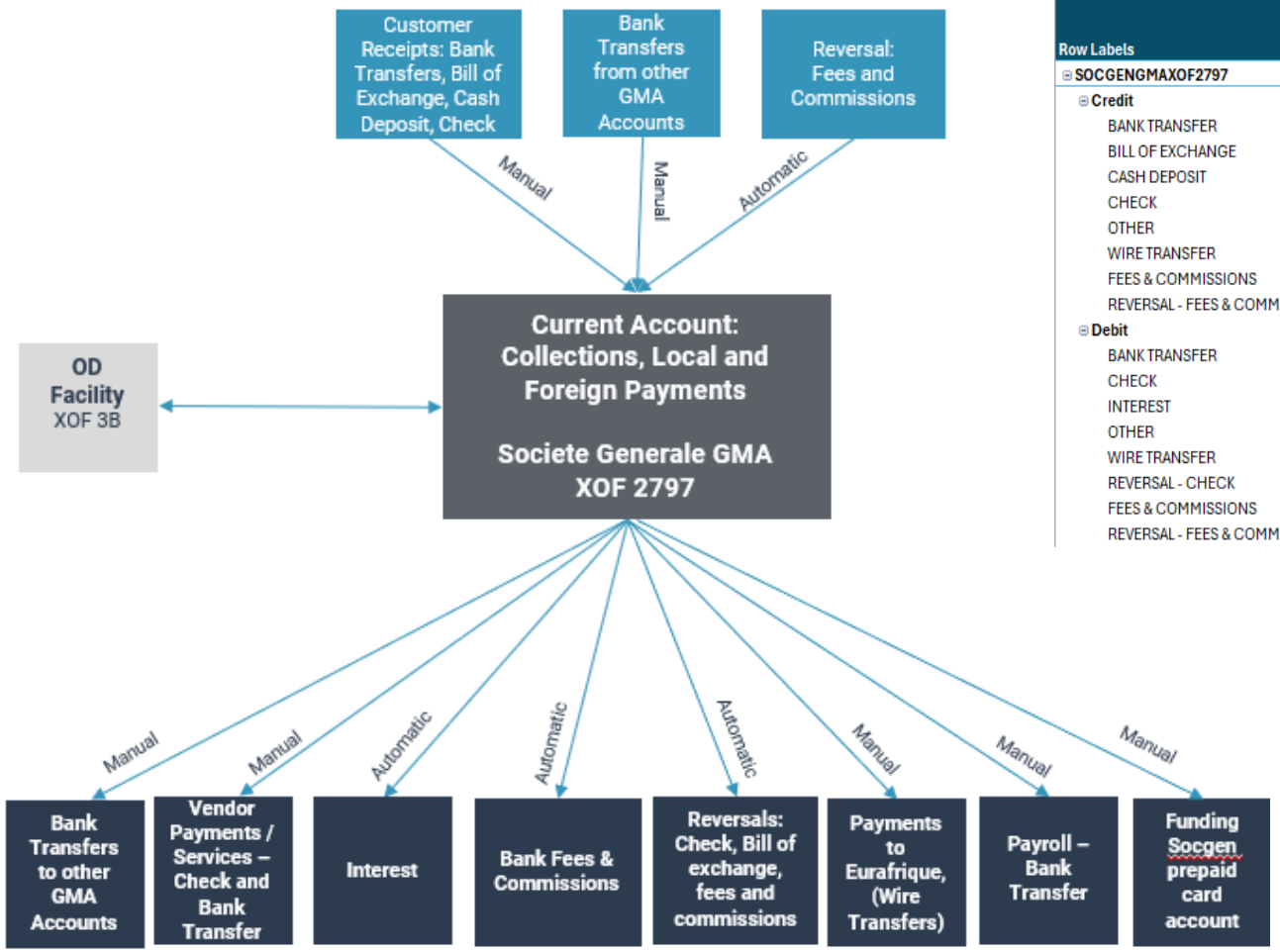

***Account Transaction Activity (Type and Volume) – 01/01/2024 to 12/31/2025:***

| Row Labels | Column Labels 2024 Transaction Amount (LCY) | Transaction Amount (USD) | # of Transactions | 2025 Transaction Amount (LCY) | Transaction Amount (USD) | # of Transactions |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **SIVGMAXOF0043** | **(4,347,709,135.00)** | **(7,763,766.31)** | **2176** | **3,686,176,879.00** | **6,582,458.71** | **1789** |
| **Credit** | **21,513,660,777.00** | **38,417,251.39** | **1334** | **26,154,388,067.00** | **46,704,264.41** | **1027** |
| BANK TRANSFER | 338,379,415.00 | 604,248.96 | 25 | 101,452,140.00 | 181,164.54 | 23 |
| BILL OF EXCHANGE | 2,438,856,730.00 | 4,355,101.30 | 142 | 1,936,277,305.00 | 3,457,638.04 | 187 |
| CASH DEPOSIT | 4,071,245,245.00 | 7,270,080.79 | 566 | 3,531,210,841.00 | 6,305,733.64 | 425 |
| CHECK | 8,835,310,156.00 | 15,777,339.56 | 579 | 2,649,802,755.00 | 4,731,790.63 | 278 |
| REVERSAL - BANK TRANSFER | 5,800,000,000.00 | 10,357,142.86 | 19 | 17,825,000,000.00 | 31,830,357.14 | 111 |
| REVERSAL - CHECK | 33,000.00 | 58.93 | 1 | 110,605,426.00 | 197,509.69 | 1 |
| REVERSAL - FEES & COMMISSIONS | 29,836,231.00 | 53,278.98 | 2 | 39,600.00 | 70.71 | 2 |
| **Debit** | **(25,861,369,912.00)** | **(46,181,017.70)** | **842** | **(22,468,211,188.00)** | **(40,121,805.69)** | **762** |
| BANK TRANSFER | (3,434,736,201.00) | (6,133,457.50) | 62 | (1,978,376,752.00) | (3,532,815.63) | 83 |
| CHECK | (15,000,000.00) | (26,785.71) | 1 | (121,515,056.00) | (216,991.17) | 3 |
| FEES & COMMISSIONS | (207,018,977.00) | (369,676.74) | 715 | (149,723,950.00) | (267,364.20) | 603 |
| INTEREST | (65,488,160.00) | (116,943.14) | 15 | (364,214,379.00) | (650,382.82) | 12 |
| OTHER | (2,200,000.00) | (3,928.57) | 1 | (390,500.00) | (697.32) | 5 |
| REVERSAL - BILL OF EXCHANGE | (66,000.00) | (117.86) | 2 | (165,000.00) | (294.64) | 5 |
| REVERSAL - CHECK | (131,255,102.00) | (234,384.11) | 20 | (706,200.00) | (1,261.07) | 22 |
| REVERSAL - FEES & COMMISSIONS | (22,000.00) | (39.29) | 2 | (28,600.00) | (51.07) | 3 |
| WIRE TRANSFER | (22,005,583,472.00) | (39,295,684.77) | 24 | (19,853,090,751.00) | (35,451,947.77) | 26 |
| **Grand Total** | **(4,347,709,135.00)** | **(7,763,766.31)** | **2176** | **3,686,176,879.00** | **6,582,458.71** | **1789** |

**NOTES**

- Account was renumerated above a certain amount – Cyril is verifying the amount and percentage.

# Bank Account Diagram – Societe Generale XOF 2797



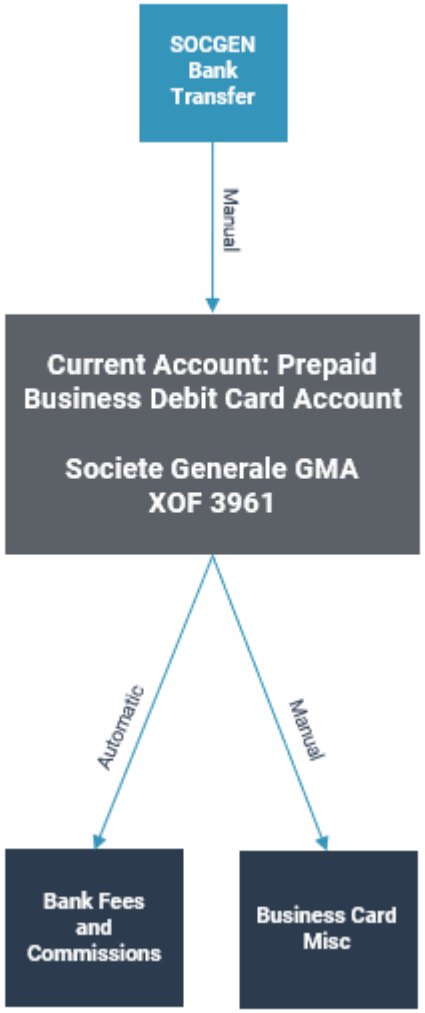

***Account.Transaction.Activity.(Type.and.Volume).-.67–67–8680..to.78–97–8680***

| Row Labels | 2024 Transaction Amount (LCY) | 2024 Transaction Amount (USD) | 2024 # of Transactions | 2025 Transaction Amount (LCY) | 2025 Transaction Amount (USD) | 2025 # of Transactions |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **SOCGENGMAXOF2797** | **2,336,232,004.00** | **4,171,842.86** | **2921** | **553,286,616.00** | **988,011.81** | **5796** |
| **Credit** | **25,841,307,155.00** | **46,145,191.35** | **1682** | **28,763,995,324.00** | **51,364,277.36** | **1865** |
| BANK TRANSFER | 792,685,378.00 | 1,415,509.60 | 120 | 1,693,936,159.00 | 3,024,886.00 | 178 |
| BILL OF EXCHANGE | 1,679,531,255.00 | 2,999,162.96 | 183 | 717,449,300.00 | 1,281,159.46 | 70 |
| CASH DEPOSIT | 2,931,898,600.00 | 5,235,533.21 | 447 | 2,425,523,475.00 | 4,331,291.92 | 490 |
| CHECK | 10,859,929,658.00 | 19,392,731.53 | 899 | 9,951,535,151.00 | 17,770,598.48 | 979 |
| OTHER | 6,280,000.00 | 11,214.29 | 1 | | | |
| WIRE TRANSFER | 9,554,379,429.00 | 17,061,391.84 | 30 | 13,975,531,989.00 | 24,956,307.12 | 124 |
| FEES & COMMISSIONS | | | | 14,025.00 | 25.04 | 5 |
| REVERSAL - FEES & COMMISSIONS | 16,602,835.00 | 29,647.92 | 2 | 5,225.00 | 9.33 | 19 |
| **Debit** | **(23,505,075,151.00)** | **(41,973,348.48)** | **1239** | **(28,210,708,708.00)** | **(50,376,265.55)** | **3931** |
| BANK TRANSFER | (627,333,920.00) | (1,120,239.14) | 65 | (5,534,652,170.00) | (9,883,307.45) | 1298 |
| CHECK | | | | (1,211,176,690.00) | (2,162,815.52) | 8 |
| INTEREST | (67,252,181.00) | (120,093.18) | 14 | (163,699,922.00) | (292,321.29) | 11 |
| OTHER | (7,225,035.00) | (12,901.85) | 4 | | | |
| WIRE TRANSFER | (21,141,565,664.00) | (37,752,795.83) | 43 | (20,238,543,733.00) | (36,140,256.67) | 68 |
| REVERSAL - CHECK | (1,511,188,983.00) | (2,698,551.76) | 119 | (921,651,124.00) | (1,645,805.58) | 82 |
| FEES & COMMISSIONS | (149,935,168.00) | (267,741.37) | 907 | (140,523,069.00) | (250,934.05) | 2394 |
| REVERSAL - FEES & COMMISSIONS | (574,200.00) | (1,025.36) | 87 | (462,000.00) | (825.00) | 70 |

**NOTES**

- Most local vendor payments are flowing out of this account.

# Bank Account Diagram – Societe Generale XOF 3961




***Account Transaction Activity (Type and Volume) – 01/01/2024 to 12/31/2025:***

| | Column Labels | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | 2024 | | | 2025 | | |
| Row Labels | Transaction Amount (LCY) | Transaction Amount (USD) | # of Transactions | Transaction Amount (LCY) | Transaction Amount (USD) | # of Transactions |
| SOCGENGMAXOF3961 | (1,612,252.00) | (2,879.02) | 95 | 1,632,289.00 | 2,914.80 | 73 |
| Credit | 17,923,000.00 | 32,005.36 | 4 | 11,885,590.00 | 21,224.27 | 5 |
| BANK TRANSFER | 17,923,000.00 | 32,005.36 | 4 | 11,885,590.00 | 21,224.27 | 5 |
| Debit | (19,535,252.00) | (34,884.38) | 91 | (10,253,301.00) | (18,309.47) | 68 |
| CARD | (19,108,610.00) | (34,122.52) | 62 | (10,000,317.00) | (17,857.71) | 44 |
| FEES & COMMISSIONS | (426,642.00) | (761.86) | 29 | (252,984.00) | (451.76) | 24 |
| Grand Total | 2,334,619,752.00 | 4,168,963.84 | 3016 | 554,918,905.00 | 990,926.62 | 5869 |

**NOTES**

- This is a sub account of the Societe Generale XOF 2797 account
- This card is for the MD (Francois) to use for business expenses (travel expenses, dinners, occasional IT group items).
- There used to be a second business card that has now been closed.

# Back / Forward Dated & Weekend Transactions

## Back & Forward Dated Transactions by Account

| Difference | (Multiple Items) | *excluding 0 | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Row Labels** | **Count of Difference** | **Average of Difference** | **Min of Difference** | **Max of Difference** |
| **Bank Atlantique IC** | **1,529** | **(7)** | **(641)** | **2** |
| **BATLGMAXOF9082** | **1,529** | **(7)** | **(641)** | **2** |
| Credit | 1,052 | (2) | (254) | 2 |
| Debit | 477 | (16) | (641) | 1 |
| **BOA Ivory Coast** | **5,963** | **(1)** | **(365)** | **5** |
| **BOAFRICAGMA0149** | **5,631** | **(1)** | **(365)** | **5** |
| Credit | 3,963 | 1 | (63) | 5 |
| Debit | 1,668 | (7) | (365) | 3 |
| **BOAFRICAGMA7551** | **332** | **(3)** | **(365)** | **3** |
| Credit | 4 | (9) | (31) | (1) |
| Debit | 328 | (3) | (365) | 3 |
| **CITI IVORY COAST** | **40** | **2** | **(3)** | **4** |
| **CITIGMAXOF0144** | **40** | **2** | **(3)** | **4** |
| Credit | 2 | (1) | (1) | (1) |
| Debit | 38 | 2 | (3) | 4 |
| **SIB (IVORIAN BANK)** | **3,753** | **0** | **(70)** | **5** |
| **SIVGMAXOF0043** | **3,753** | **0** | **(70)** | **5** |
| Credit | 2,304 | 0 | (70) | 5 |
| Debit | 1,449 | 0 | (49) | 5 |
| **SOCGEN Ivory Coast** | **4,308** | **(0)** | **(188)** | **5** |
| **SOCGENGMAXOF2797** | **4,160** | **(0)** | **(188)** | **5** |
| Credit | 2,298 | 1 | (71) | 5 |
| Debit | 1,862 | (2) | (188) | 4 |
| **SOCGENGMAXOF3961** | **148** | **(2)** | **(7)** | **(1)** |
| Credit | 8 | (2) | (3) | (1) |
| Debit | 140 | (2) | (7) | (1) |

## Number of Weekend Transactions by Account

| Count of Amount | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Row Labels** | **6** | **7** |
| **AFG BK** | | |
| AFGGMAXOF0416 | | |
| **Bank Atlantique IC** | **16** | **11** |
| BATLGMAXOF9082 | 16 | 11 |
| **BOA Ivory Coast** | **41** | **75** |
| BOAFRICAGMA0149 | 33 | 61 |
| BOAFRICAGMA7551 | 8 | 14 |
| **CITI IVORY COAST** | **2** | **1** |
| CITIGMAXOF0144 | 2 | 1 |
| **MTN Mobile FS CI** | **515** | **62** |
| MTNGMAXOF6151 | 515 | 62 |
| **SIB (IVORIAN BANK)** | **4** | **3** |
| SIVGMAXOF0043 | 4 | 3 |
| **SOCGEN Ivory Coast** | **12** | **21** |
| SOCGENGMAXOF2797 | 4 | 6 |
| SOCGENGMAXOF3961 | 8 | 15 |
| **Grand Total** | **590** | **173** |

Source: IT2 Transaction data 2024 & 2025.

# Account Dashboard (expressed in USD)

Last Refresh
26, Feb, 2026 06:06 AM (-05:00)

Company
GMA

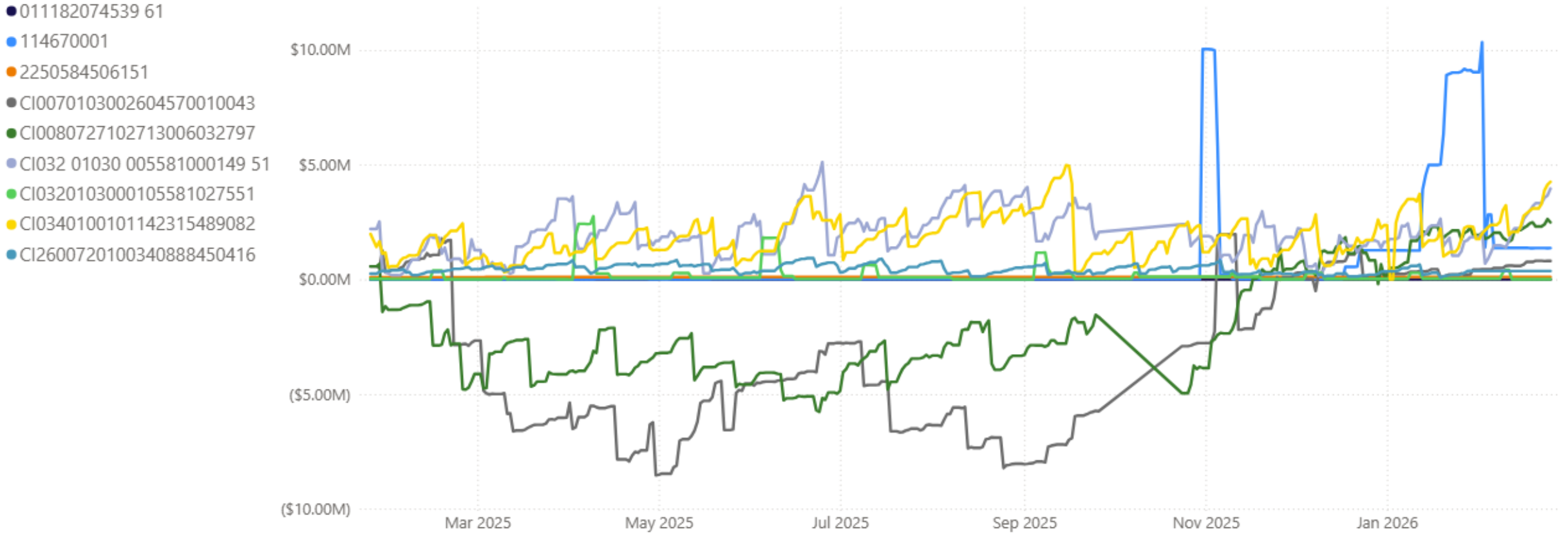
Bank
Multiple Selected

Division
SOTG DIVISION

Filter

| Active Accounts | Active Companies | Active Banks | Currencies | Countries | Prior Month Max | Prior 12 Month Max | Prior 12 Month Avg |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 9 | 1 | 7 | 1 | 1 | $17.4M | $17.4M | $181.4K |

## LTM Daily Balances
(Accounts / USD Equivalent)




Line Graph Details

SEABOARD CORPORATION

# Other Considerations

| OTHER |
| --- |
| • In certain bank platforms, if you enter a payment above XOF 50M it will automatically convert to a wire transfer going through STAR. Below XOF 50M there is a choice between ACH and a wire. For other banking platforms (Atlantique), there is a choice regardless of the amount. Cyril to get back to us which banks fall under what.<br>• Depots have a recommended limit for how much cash they should have. When they reach the limit, they should go to the nearest bank to deposit the cash. Even if they don't hit the limit, at the end of the day they may take the cash out of the safe and take it to the bank. The frequency of cash being deposited at the bank depends on the depot – for those making a lot of money they need to send money to the bank almost daily. For others, as long as they are below the threshold may keep cash at the depots longer. Cyril is sending the threshold.<br>• There are certain types of transactions called Saisie's where the court will order the bank to freeze your account or transaction (verifying with Cyril) because a vendor will bring a dispute to the court. In this case, the amount is frozen, and once there is a ruling the court unfreezes it. This happens at most banks except for BOA. Working with Cyril to identify these transactions. |

# Payroll

NOTES

Currently, payroll is being paid through SIB, Bank Atlantique, Societe Generale, and Bank of Africa. They try to pay employees who have matching banks as much as possible, and then those who don't have an account at one of the four banks are paid to their individual account. Under the current state, the reasoning for payroll to be paid out of the separate banks is to reduce banking fees and provide same day payroll payments when possible. If paying through non-matching banks the payments take 1-2 days.

With the rollout of PI-SPI, there is an opportunity to consolidate the payroll to same day funding out of one bank. What will need to still be assessed is the cost associated with this. SIB and BOA are currently on the PI-SPI platform with Societe Generale also working on joining.

| Banques Salaires | Montant | Virer par |
|---|---|---|
| BACI | 12,101,000 | BACI |
| AFG BANK ABIDJAN | 369,000 | SIB |
| AFG BANK SAN PEDRO | 884,500 | SIB |
| BIAO | 4,064,583 | SGCI |
| BICICI | 11,728,000 | SGCI |
| BNI ABIDJAN | 6,859,500 | SIB |
| BNI SAN PEDRO | 1,314,500 | SIB |
| BOA | 12,328,500 | BOA |
| BSIC | 931,500 | SIB |
| ECOBANK ABIDJAN | 16,051,500 | SIB |
| ORANGE BANK | 1,910,000 | SIB |
| SGBCI ABIDJAN | 45,107,069 | SGCI |
| ECOBANK SAN PEDRO | 763,500 | SIB |
| SGBCI SAN PEDRO | 1,783,000 | SGCI |
| SIB ABIDJAN | 24,790,913 | SIB |
| SIB SAN PEDRO | 3,624,000 | SIB |
| CORIS BANK | 643,500 | SIB |
| BDA | 777,500 | SIB |
| BDU | 767,000 | SIB |
| ORABANK | 675,000 | SIB |
| ESPECE | - | ESPECE |
| **Total virement salaire Abidjan - San Ped** | **147,474,065** | |

# Future Dated Checks & Bills of Exchange

## CHECKS

Some customers will future date checks as part of their payment terms with GMA. These checks are placed in a safe at GMA until their future date arrives, and then they are taken to the bank to be cashed. GMA cannot take them to the bank immediately as the bank will cash them, so this process was established.

Daily, the local treasury person (Joelle in this case) will open the safe and review if there are any checks that need to be cashed (they are placed in order as they're received). If so, she will have it endorsed and take it to the bank. When she is out, they have a backup for her.
If the date of the check falls on a weekend or holiday, they can take the check in the next business day with no issue.

Even if there are funds in the account before the date of the check, we don't want to cash it before the date as it can affect our customer's cashflow.

## BILLS OF EXCHANGE

Bills of exchange are a similar instrument to checks. They come in a book the same way checks do. When completing the bill, they will complete with a future date. A customer who has certain agreed upon payment terms (30 days for example) completes the bill for 30 days from the day they pick up the flour. The day this is received from the customer, the bill of exchange is endorsed, and taken to the bank. The bank will then cash it on the date of the bill.

Each bank offers a financing product called affactourage for bills of exchange. This would allow GMA to receive the cash now for payments due in a future date. Cyril stated that this product is expensive in the Ivory Coast and would destroy their margin.

## OTHER CHECK NOTES

In the Ivory Coast it takes at least 2 hours for each visit to the bank. For this reason, GMA started offering a solution if an employee needs XOF 200,000 (~$350) or less at any time. How it works is they can write a check to GMA for the amount of cash needed, and GMA will cash it for them there. This happens maybe once every month or two, it is not common. They cannot do a second check until the money is received from the first.

Reversals used to be more frequent, but GMA is receiving less checks each year, so the number of reversals is decreasing with time.

There have been times where the banks will reject a check even when there were no issues with the check to obtain the fees for unpaid checks. They may say there was an issue with the signature or not enough funds in the account when this is not the case.

# Bank Users – as of Q3 2025

| Account Location | (Multiple Items) |
|---|---|

| Count of Email | Column Labels | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Row Labels | Payment Approval | Payment Initiation | View Only | Grand Total |
| Les Grand Moulin D Abidjan (0149) | 6 | 4 | 1 | 11 |
| CTM Division | 6 | 4 | 1 | 11 |
| Les Grands Moulins d Abidjan ( 0043) | 6 | 3 | | 9 |
| CTM Division | 6 | 3 | | 9 |
| Les Grands Moulins d Abidjan ( 2797) | 6 | 4 | | 10 |
| CTM Division | 6 | 4 | | 10 |
| Les Grands Moulins d Abidjan ( 9082) | 6 | 3 | | 9 |
| CTM Division | 6 | 3 | | 9 |
| Les Grands Moulins d Abidjan (0416) | | | 1 | 1 |
| CTM Division | | | 1 | 1 |
| Les Grands Moulins d Abidjan (3961) | 6 | 4 | | 10 |
| CTM Division | 6 | 4 | | 10 |
| Les Grands Moulins d Abidjan (7551) | 6 | 4 | 1 | 11 |
| CTM Division | 6 | 4 | 1 | 11 |
| Grand Total | 36 | 22 | 3 | 61 |

Accounts missing from the above: Citibank 0144, MTN Mobile FS 6151

## AUTHORIZED SIGNERS

- Adriana Hoskins (7, not on CITI nor MTN Mobile)
- Cyril Edorh (7, not on CITI nor MTN Mobile)
- Francois Frederic Dominique Menenteau (7, not on CITI nor MTN Mobile)
- Gregory Stough (8 not on MTN Mobile)
- Jules-Oliver Kouame (8 not on MTN Mobile)
- Maximilien Loic Barbosa (7, not on CITI nor MTN Mobile)
- Robert L. Steer(7, not on CITI nor MTN Mobile)
- Dave, Emma, and Ben are not signers on any accounts. The accounts team is working on this.

## AUTHORIZED REPRESENTATIVES

- Adriana Hoskins (7, not on CITI nor MTN Mobile)
- Robert L. Steer (7, not on CITI nor MTN Mobile)
- Francois Frederic Dominique Menenteau (1, only on CITI)

# Foreign Exchange Summary

BCEAO (the Central Bank of West African States) is responsible for the pooling of the Union foreign exchange reserve.

All international transfers must transit via an approved intermediary (i.e., a local bank), with supporting documents justifying the transaction — such as contracts, invoices, sales documents, or board minutes in the case of dividend distribution — as well as compliance with tax and exchange control legislation. They must comply with domiciliation requirements under the new 2024 WAEMU regulation.

Transfers in FYC below XOF 500,000 do not require any justification or documentation. However, all transfers in FCY above XOF 500,000 do require documentation justification as requested by Central Bank. Besdie is the 2024 checklist for these transfers:

| | Importation of Goods | Importation of Services | Salary Payment | Foreign Airlines Repatriation | Dividends | Foreign Loan Repayment | Travel Allowance |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Commercial Invoice / Advance Invoice | X | X | | | | | |
| Import Declaration (FDI) | X | | | | | | |
| Approved Digital FX Form (Ac GUCE) - Validity: 1 Month | X | | | | | | |
| Transport Document (BI / LTA) | X | | | | | | |
| Custom Document | X | | | | | | |
| Payslip | | | X | | | | |
| Approved Manual FX Form | | X | X | X | X | X | X |
| Reminder Letter/Email for Overdue Invoices | X | X | | | | | |
| WHT Certificate (or Explanation Letter) / Proof of Tax Exemption | | X | | | | | |
| Certificate of Service Acceptance | | X | | | | | |
| Agreement / Contract of services (or any document in its place) / Work Contract | | X | X | | | | |
| Valid Passport | | | X | | | | X |
| Tax certificate (Certificate of Fiscal Regularity) | | | | X | | | |
| Statutes or RCCM of the Foreign Airlines Company | | | | X | | | |

Source: Citibank Country Profile 2025

# Foreign Exchange Summary

## Convertibility

Convertible with restrictions subject to local exchange control regulation. FCY (Foreign Currency) to LCY (Local Currency) is free while LCY to FCY is subject to supporting documentation in line with the local exchange regulation.

## Restrictions

Resident corporate to hedge risk only based on commercial transaction, no speculative hedging allowed. FCY account opening are subject to Ministry of Finance and Central bank explicit approval.

## Capital Control

Capital flows and FDI (Foreign Direct Investment) are not subject to any restriction, however, would need to be declared to the MoF (Ministry of Finance) office at inception to facilitate reimbursement.

| | Importation of Goods | Importation of Services | Salary Payment | Foreign Airlines Repatriation | Dividends | Foreign Loan Repayment | Travel Allowance |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Certified Periodic Report of Ticketing Operations | | | | X | | | |
| Certified Financials Reports | | | | | X | | |
| Minutes of the General Assembly Authorizing the Distribution of Profits | | | | | X | | |
| Board of Director Report | | | | | X | | |
| Auditor's Report | | | | | X | | |
| Certified Distribution List of Dividends Bearing Names and Addresses of the Beneficiaries | | | | | X | | |
| Tax (IRVM) Payment Attestation (or copy of the IRVM payment check + Deposit Receipt + Extract from the Account Statement Certifying Payment of the IRVM) | | | | | X | | |
| Certificate of Tax Regularity | | | | | X | | |
| Certificate of CI's Securities Subscription (For Mobile Telephone Companies) | | | | | X | | |
| Approval of the Commercial Court for any payment of dividends to be issued of after September 30th (Article 146 of the OHADA Uniform Act.) | | | | | X | | |
| Letter from the Public Treasury relating to the Declaration of the loan abroad | | | | | | X | |
| Credit Advice evidencing the entry of funds through a bank | | | | | | X | |
| Contract or Loan Agreement, translated into French by a sworn translator | | | | | | X | |
| Loan Report Drawn up on Form N.57 | | | | | | X | |
| Reimbursement report drawn up on Form N.59 | | | | | | X | |
| Amortization Table of The Loan (Optional) | | | | | | X | |
| Proof of Statistical Declaration of the loan and the repayment to Central Bank | | | | | | X | |
| Copy of Air Ticket | | | | | | | X |
| Statement of expenses, if the equivalent amount exceeds XOF 2 million | | | | | | | X |

Source: Citibank Country Profile 2025

# Trade Transaction Framework

## PAYMENT & BANKING

All import payments must flow through **approved intermediary banks**

**Required docs:** transfer forms, invoices & justification documents (refer to slide 33 & 34)

**Import Declaration Required**
Mandatory for all goods from outside the franc zone, filed with an approved bank — **except:**

- Shipments valued ≤ XOF 1 million
- Non-payment imports (require Ministry of Finance prior authorization)

## WAEMU TARIFF STRUCTURE

| | |
|---|---|
| Cat. 0 — Essential goods | 0% |
| Cat. I — Raw materials / equipment | 5% |
| Cat. II — Intermediary goods | 10% |
| Cat. III — Consumer goods | 20% |
| Cat. IV — Strategic dev. goods | 35% |

## 2024 REFORM — REG. 06/2024

**Effective December 20, 2024**
*Replaces Regulation 09/2010*

**Key changes:**

- All transfers via authorized banks/MFIs
- Mandatory reporting to monetary authorities
- Domiciliation required above CB (central bank) threshold
- Export proceeds must be fully repatriated
- FX derivatives now permitted for hedging

# Three Legal Regimes for Imports

*How goods are classified determines the process required to import them into Côte d'Ivoire. Grains and mill spare parts fall under category 1 : Import Freedom Arrangement*

## IMPORT FREEDOM ARRANGEMENT 01

***Default — Least Restrictive***

The baseline regime for most goods entering Côte d'Ivoire.

**How it works:**
Goods may be imported freely without prior government authorization, subject to standard customs documentation and payment through an approved intermediary bank.

**Key requirement:**
Import declaration filed with an approved bank for all non-franc zone shipments above XOF 1 million.

## SYSTEM OF APPROVAL 02

***Controlled — Prior Authorization Required***

Applies to goods that require government oversight before import can proceed.

**How it works:**
Importer must obtain prior approval from the relevant authority (typically the Ministry of Commerce) before shipment. Approval is product- and use-specific.

**Typical products:**
Pharmaceuticals, chemicals, certain food products, agricultural inputs, and goods with safety or public health implications.

## LIMITATION REGIME 03

***Restricted — Quotas or Bans Apply***

The most restrictive regime, used to protect strategic or sensitive sectors.

**How it works:**
Imports are subject to quantitative limits (quotas) or may be prohibited outright. Restrictions are set by government decree and reviewed periodically.

**Typical products:**
Certain textiles, used vehicles, arms and defense materials, and goods protected under WAEMU regional trade policy.

# Debt Facilities

| Bank | Bank Group | Currency | Facility Type | Facility Amount | Interest Rate |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Societe Generale | Societe Generale (France) | XOF | Overdraft | 3,000,000,000 | 5.5% |
| SIB (Societe Ivoirienne de Banque) | Attijariwafa Bank | XOF | Overdraft | 5,000,000,000 | 6.5% |

**FACILITY OPENINGS**

- GMA is opening an overdraft facility with CITI for XOF 3B – 5B

# Letter of Credit Facilities

| Seaboard Applicant | Ref Number (issued by bank) | Issuing Bank | Beneficiary | Reason for Letter of Credit Issuance | Line of Credit? | Ccy | Amount (LCY) | Amount (USD Equivalent) | Issue Date | Maturity Date | 3rd Party Bank Statement provided to Corp? |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Grands Moulins d'Abidjan (GMA) | LG12/795 | Bank Of Africa | Port of Abidjan | Port Authorities of Abidjan Land | Not Line of Credit | XOF | 78,897,000 | $140,760 | 4/3/2025 | 4/2/2030 | Yes |
| Grands Moulins d'Abidjan (GMA) | | Bank Of Africa | Port of Abidjan | Port Authorities of Abidjan - Warehouse #1 Lease | Not Line of Credit | XOF | 48,250,000 | $86,003 | 11/1/2025 | 10/30/2026 | Unknown |
| Grands Moulins d'Abidjan (GMA) | N/A | Societe Ivoirienne de Banque (SIB) | Cote d'Ivoire Customs Agency | To cover customs brokerage operations | Not Line of Credit | XOF | 410,000,000 | $731,482 | 1/1/2024 | 12/31/2025 | Yes |

**NOTE:**

For LC Reference Number LG12/795: Bank Guarantee rejected by Port, will never be exercised. The guarantee expired in 2015, but bank needs a release letter from Port to remove from their books. We have been unable to obtain a release letter so far. Port only provided a letter saying they do not recognize the guarantee, but not good enough for the bank. Actions are underway to cancel the bank guarantee.

In November 2025, the previous LC for Warehouse #1 Lease for XOF 41.4M was replaced with the above LC for XOF 48.25M. We increased our space by 600m2.

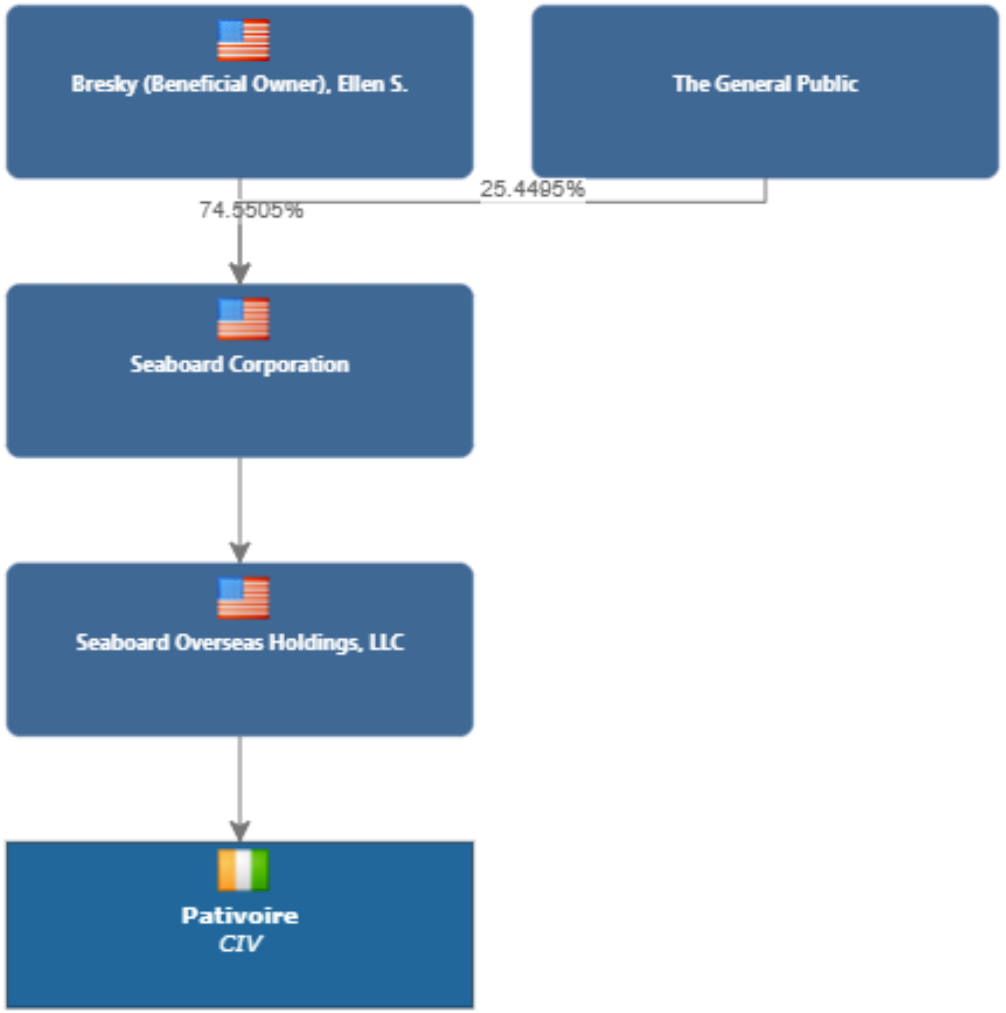
It would be possible to transition any of the letters of credit to another bank if we decided that is what we wanted. There would be a small cost associated with it.

# Business Strategy Structure - Pativoire

**Overview**
**Location & Physical Presence**
**Products**
Pativoire plans to sell 80%-85% of their product at the base quality brand level. They will launch with discounts on price, while quality is slightly higher, compared to their competitors in the short run, and plan to increase prices to match competitors in the long term. They plan to sell 5%-10% of their product as a premium brand, and the other 5%-10% of their product as a low cost brand.

**Scale & Capacity**
Pativoire plans to use the wheat from GMA as the input for their pasta production. The expected capacity of the pasta plant is 50,000 MT of long and short pasta per year.
**Market Position**
The aim is for Pativoire to have more than 22% (50,000 MT) of market share within 5 years. The focus is on major cities in Cote d'Ivoire where there is a higher concentration of households with disposable income and a preference for convenience foods. The channels for distribution of the pasta include GMA depots, supermarkets, local grocery stores, catering services, and exports.

# Legal & Tax Structure - Pativoire




**NOTES**

Pativoire is in the process of opening a bank account with Citibank.

We are working on establishing the CIO product in CITI account.

# Accounts & Flows

NOTES

Pativoire is in the process of opening a bank account with Citibank.

We are working on establishing the CIO product in CITI account.

# Pain Points to resolve

- Collection in remote areas (Number 1 issue). Avoid cash and paper-based collection instruments
- Payment efficiency and counterparty risk reduction
- Resolve for trapped liquidity
- Bank processing times

# Funds Availability by Payment Type

*Settlement periods are at the interbank/clearing level. Customer credit may take longer due to internal bank processing, batch cycles, correspondent chains, and AML/KYC holds.*

| Payment Type | System / Route | Interbank Settlement | Customer Funds Available | Notes / Source |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Wire Transfer ≥ XOF 50M** | STAR-UEMOA (RTGS) | **Immediate / Real-time** | Minutes to same day (bank processing) | *Irrevocable. No batch cycle. SWIFT format. bceao.int/en/content/star-uemoa* |
| **ACH Transfer < XOF 50M** | SICA-UEMOA (ACH) | **D+0 to D+1** | D+1 to D+2 (bank-to-customer) | *One session/day. Missing cut-off = next day. bceao.int/en/content/sica-uemoa* |
| **Cheque** | SICA-UEMOA (ACH) | **D+1** | D+2 (or longer) no official rule mandating when a customer must receive funds after a cheque is deposited. | *Physical presentation required. No BCEAO rule on max bank delay. bceao.int/en/content/sica-uemoa* |
| **Bill of Exchange / Promissory Note** | SICA-UEMOA (ACH) | **D+1** | Per agreed commercial terms | *No XOF 50M cap for commercial bills. bceao.int/en/content/sica-uemoa* |
| **Debit / Credit Card** | GIM-UEMOA → STAR | **Auth: real-time**<br>**Net settle: end of day** | Immediate (debit) / D+1 credit card | *GIM-UEMOA switch; Mastercard/Verve partners. cb-umoa.org (oversight)* |
| **Mobile Money (EMI wallets)** | EMI internal / GIM-UEMOA | **Instant (within EMI)** | Instant within same operator<br>D+0–1 cross-operator (pre-PI-SPI) | *BCEAO Instruction 008-05-2015. bceao.int — EMI rules* |
| **PI-SPI Instant Payment** | PI-SPI (BCEAO) — All providers | **Instant — 24/7** | **Immediate (irrevocable)** | *Launched Oct. 2025. 45 institutions. Partial adoption. bceao.int (BCEAO-operated)* |
| **Direct Debit (Prélèvement)** | SICA-UEMOA (draw-down notice) | **D+0 to D+1** | D+1 (creditor account credited) | *Pre-authorisation required. SICA 'avis de prélèvements'. bceao.int/en/content/sica-uemoa* |
| **International Wire Transfer** | BCEAO / licensed intermediary | **D+1 to D+5+ (varies)** | D+1 to D+5+ (correspondent chain) | *FX rules: Règlement 06/2024. MoF auth for large amounts. bceao.int — Règlement 06/2024* |

*Sources: BCEAO STAR-UEMOA · BCEAO SICA-UEMOA (bceao.int) · BCEAO Instruction 008-05-2015 · Règlement n°06/2024 · Instruction 001-01-2024 · Invest-Time Oct. 2025*

# PI-SPI Payment System

**Website:** Accueil | SPI - BCEAO
**There are plans for more banks to join the system including Societe Generale.**

**Once PI-SPI is completed, the e-CFA project will begin for the BCEAO. This is in early stages with no defined timeline.**

**01**

**Authenticate**

User logs into their bank, mobile money, or microfinance app via PIN, password, or biometrics.

**02**

**Initiate Payment**

Enter or scan the recipient's PI-SPI alias — phone number, QR code, or payment address — and input amount.

**03**

**Confirm Beneficiary**

Centralized alias directory auto-displays recipient's name & country, reducing errors.

**04**

**Instant Settlement**

Payment clears in under 10 seconds. Both parties receive instant confirmation — any institution, any country.

*Works across banks · microfinance institutions · mobile money providers · payment operators — regardless of network or institution*

**Liste des participants autorisés à ouvrir les services de PI-SPI au public**

**BÉNIN (6)**
- BOA
- CORIS BANK
- ECOBANK
- ORABANK
- UBA
- MOOV MONEY

**BURKINA (8)**
- BOA
- CORIS BANK
- ECOBANK
- ORABANK
- UBA
- ORANGE MONEY
- BAOBAB
- COFINA

**COTE D'IVOIRE (15)**
- AFRIKA BANQUE
- BMS
- BNI
- BOA
- BRIDGE BANK
- CORIS BANK
- ECOBANK
- MANSA BANK
- ORABANK
- ORANGE BANK AFRICA
- SIB
- UBA
- ORANGE MONEY
- BAOBAB
- COFINA

**GUINÉE BISSAU (4)**
- BDU
- CORIS BANK
- ECOBANK
- ORABANK

**MALI (9)**
- BCI MALI
- BDM
- BIM
- BMS
- CORIS BANK
- ECOBANK
- ORABANK
- UBA
- BOABAB

**NIGER (4)**
- BOA
- CORIS BANK
- ECOBANK
- ORABANK

**SÉNÉGAL (18)**
- AFRIKA BANQUE
- BNDE
- BOA
- BRIDGE BANK
- CBAO, GROUPE ATTIJARIWAFA BANK
- CORIS BANK
- CREDIT DU SENEGAL
- ECOBANK
- FBNBANK
- ORABANK
- ORANGE BANK AFRICA
- UBA
- MOBILE CASH SA (MIXX SÉNÉGAL)
- ORANGE FINANCES MOBILES
- TOUCHPOINT FINANCIAL SERVICES
- BAOBAB
- UM-ACEP
- UM-PAMECAS

**TOGO (6)**
- BIA
- BOA
- CORIS BANK
- ECOBANK
- ORABANK
- COFINA

# Electronic Money Issuing (EMI) Institutions

ELECTRONIC MONEY ISSUING INSTITUTIONS AS OF JUNE 30, 2025

| COUNTRY | TOTAL NUMBER OF INITIATIVES | STATE TREASURY | LICENSED NON BANK ELECTRONIC MONEY ISSUERS | MICROFINANCE INSTITUTIONS AUTHORIZED TO ISSUE ELECTRONIC MONEY | COMMERCIAL BANKS ISSUING E-MONEY VIA A PARTNERSHIP WITH TELECOMMUNICATIONS OPERATORS OR TECHNICAL SERVICES PROVIDERS | | | SUPPPORT OR USE CHANNEL | PRODUCT NAME |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | BANKS | TELECOMMUNICATIONS OPERATORS | TECHNICAL SERVICES PROVIDERS | | |
| COTE D'IVOIRE | 20 | | ORANGE MONEY CÔTE D'IVOIRE | | | | | Cell phone | ORANGE MONEY |
| | | | MTN MOBILE FINANCIAL SERVICES COTE D'IVOIRE | | | | | Cell phone | MTN MOBILE MONEY/ MoMo |
| | | | MOOV MONEY CÔTE D'IVOIRE | | | | | Cell phone | MOOV MONEY |
| | | | DJOGANA PAY | | | | | Cell phone | PE YA PAY |
| | | | | CELPAID | | | | Cell phone | CELPAID MONEY |
| | | | | | UBA CI | | WAVE | Cell phone | WAVE |
| | | | | | UBA CI | | SAMA MONEY SA | Cell phone | SAMA MONEY |
| | | | | | Coris Bank International Côte d'Ivoire | | CORIS HOLDING (Solution interne) | Cell phone | Coris Money |
| | | | | | BACI | | WIZALL | Cell phone | WIZALL |
| | | | | | BDA | | KASH KASH (Solution interne) | Cell phone | KASH KASH |
| | | | | | BRM | | XIKKA | Cell phone | XIKKA MONEY |
| | | | | | ORABANK CI | | WAVE | Cell phone | WAVE |
| | | | | | BGFI Bank | | DJAMO-CI | Prepaid cards | Prepaid cards BGFI CI-DJAMO |
| | | | | | BSIC CI | | COLOW SO | Prepaid cards | Prepaid cards BSIC/COLOW SO |
| | | | | | Mansa bank | | DJOGONA | Prepaid cards | Prepaid cards co-branded MANSABANK-DJOGANA |
| | | | | | Orange Banque (OBA) | | OMCI ET société International Card Processing Services (ICPS) | Prepaid cards | Prepaid cards co-branded OBA-OMCI |
| | | | | | AFRILAND (Afriland First Bank Côte d'Ivoire) | | NanoBNK et Intelligentsia | Cell phone | SARA MONEY |
| | | | | | ECOBANK CI | | CashXpress | Cell phone | XPRESS |
| | | | | | BNI | | SYCA PAY | Cell phone | B. FREE |
| | | Banque du Trésor de Côte d'Ivoire | | | | | | Cell phone | TRESOR MONEY |

List of electronic money issuing institutions as of jun 30, 2025_DGCC

# Worked Example: How Money Moves Through EMI → PI-SPI → STAR

**Scenario:** Kofi (Orange Money customer, Abidjan) sends XOF 50,000 to Aminata (MTN Mobile Money customer, Bouaké) — an inter-operator transfer across two different EMIs.

## 1

### Initiation (EMI — Orange Money)

- Kofi opens the Orange Money app and enters Aminata's phone number (her PI-SPI alias) + XOF 50,000
- Orange Money authenticates Kofi (PIN / biometric) and checks his wallet balance & account tier limits
- Orange Money sends a payment instruction to PI-SPI identifying sender alias, recipient alias, amount, and timestamp

## 2

### Clearing & Routing (PI-SPI — BCEAO)

- PI-SPI receives the instruction and queries its central alias database — resolves Aminata's phone number to her MTN Mobile Money account
- PI-SPI validates the transaction (format, AML screening, participant authorization)
- PI-SPI instantly notifies MTN Mobile Money to credit Aminata's wallet — funds available in < 10 seconds
- Transaction is logged in PI-SPI's full audit trail for regulatory review

## 3

### Net Settlement (STAR-UEMOA — BCEAO)

- PI-SPI accumulates all inter-operator obligations throughout the day (Orange → MTN, MTN → Moov, etc.)
- At end of cycle, net multilateral balances are passed to STAR-UEMOA for final gross settlement
- STAR debits Orange Money's BCEAO account and credits MTN's account in real time
- If Orange Money is short, it can draw an intra-day advance from BCEAO backed by collateral
- Settlement is final & irrevocable — Aminata's credit is fully confirmed

**Key facts:** PI-SPI transfer free for individuals | Funds available to Aminata in < 10 seconds | Orange Money float debited immediately; net position settled end-of-day via STAR | Full audit trail held by BCEAO | Transaction reported to CENTIF if threshold triggered

# Citibank Questions – Cutoff times

**What are the correct cutoff times:**

- **Would this vary by bank?**

### Funds Availability Schedule

| Clearing Stream (CS) | Cut-off Time (Local) | Funding Date | Client DR/CR Date | Client Value Date |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Local Currency Electronic Transfers (DFT) | 15:00 | D | D | D |
| Book-to-Book Transfers | 15:00 | D | D | D |
| Foreign Currency Transfers (*) | 15:00 | Subject to availability of currency | D | D |
| Cheque Deposit | 14:30 | D | D | D+2 |

### Other Payment and Clearing Considerations for Treasury

- The clearing systems were recently automated in Cote d'Ivoire and the other eight West African countries governed by the BCEAO (West African Central Bank). They are using the following main clearing systems.
- STAR-UEMOA: "Système de Transfert Automatisé et de Règlement dans l'UEMOA"
- Real-Time Gross Settlement (RTGS) system of BCEAO. This is used for same day value transfers, mainly for transfers above 50 Million Fcfa. The cutoff time for sending RTGS transactions is 17H00.
- SICA-UEMOA: "System Inter-bancaire de Compensation Automatisée de l'UEMOA"
- Automated Clearing House of UEMOA. This is used for D+1 value date.

## Clearing Systems

In the UEMOA region comprising of eight West African countries, there is only one West Africa Central Bank, BCEAO. All the banks in specific countries refer to its corresponding main branch that host clearing access points for all the banks. Clearing systems are also implemented uniformly across this region and governed by BCEAO.

The following are the main clearing system available in the region:

- **STAR-UEMOA**: "Système de Transfert Automatisé et de Règlement dans l'UEMOA" – Real Time Gross Settlement (RTGS) system of WAEMU – It is a system of BCEAO. This is used for same day value transfers and for transactions amount above XOF 50 million. The branch cut-off time for RTGS transactions is 3:30 PM.
- **SICA-UEMOA**: "System Interbancaire de Compensation Automatisée de l'UEMOA" – Automated Clearing House of WAEMU – The branch cut-off time for SICA is 3:30 PM. There is also a limit of XOF50 million for transfers initiated through SICA. Clearing is electronic and is centralized in Abidjan. Therefore, participants route data and scanned copies of instruments covered such as cheques, trade bills and VIB (local transfers) to the Automated Clearing House in Abidjan. Regional LCY funds transfers are also available vide the RTGS within the WAEMU region.

# Citibank Questions – Other

1. There is mention of cash being the predominant method of payment in the Country Profile. With the takeover of mobile money in recent years, do you have an estimate of what the breakdown of total cash payment volumes and amounts are?
2. Are there plans to enroll in the PI-SPI Payment System in the near term? This would be a priority for us.

# Outstanding Questions for GMA (has been shared with them)

1. **Bank Transfer Methods Verification:** Check with Joelle whether the bank platform provides an option to select ACH or wire when entering a transaction. (Cyril)
2. **Business Structure Documentation:** Check with Francois for any existing slides or documentation on GMA's business structure, especially regarding depots, bakeries, and mills, and share relevant materials. (Cyril)
    1. Send a chicken scratch of how the flows work between cash/checks/BOE/etc collected at the depots/GMA and how they integrate with the business structure
3. **Customer Location Data:** Pull the list of customers making deposits at AFG and consult with the commercial team to identify which are located in remote areas. (Cyril) – goal is to understand what portion of our customers are paying from where – not sure if the commercial team has any of this information
4. **Bank Fee Structure:** Provide information on the fee structure, including tranches and charges for different payment types, and how fees are applied or grouped by banks. (Cyril)
5. **Payroll Process Optimization:** Review the current payroll process and assess the feasibility and cost implications of consolidating payroll payments through the PSI platform, including potential fee differences. (Cyril)
6. **Bank Account Transaction Clarification:** Check and confirm the nature of small positive transactions (potentially depot cash deposits) in the SIB account and provide clarification. (Cyril, Joelle)
7. **Pain Points for Review:** Send Ashley a list of any additional pain points or operational challenges to be considered in the review process. (Cyril)
8. **Confirm renumeration amounts and which banks if any are still renumerating.** What is the threshold for them to start renumerating? What % did we get?
9. **Research PSI Rollout**: What is the timeline for the rollout? What are the fees associated with it (better/worse)?
10. **Discrepancy between 410m vs 500m CFA customs guarantee** references Cyril questioned this and said it needs to be verified, as the actual guarantee has always been 410m CFA.
    1. Do we have any documentation of the 410M amount?
11. **Bran Sales:** Are the bran sales billed in eur and paid in xof for eurafrique? Billed in xof, paid in xof for GMD?
12. **AFG Sweep:** How often is AFG swept/what is the threshold amount?
    1. Do you send this via bank transfer, wire transfer, or check?
13. **Payroll:** Have there ever been payroll disputes? If this is the case, does this freeze your account?
14. **Frozen Transactions**: For the Saisie transactions, is the amount frozen a disputed amount, or is that the amount in your entire account at the time?
    1. There were a lot of eurafrique transactions with saisie in the comment but then the reversal never took place. Could it mean something else?
    2. You don't have a list of all Saisie transactions do you?
15. **MTN Sweep:** How long is it taking the MTN funds to show up in the BOA bank account? In 2024 some of the transfers were taking 10+ days. We don't have the 2025 data for MTN so unable to review.
    1. There were also some instances where there were funds debited from the MTN account and then credited back into the MTN account – do you know what would be happening in this case?
16. **Cutoff Times:** What are the cutoff times for each bank to process payments / receipts?
17. **Depots:** What is the depot cash limit? Do you have information of volumes by depots? Are there any products used to mitigate risk at the higher volume depots?
18. **Policy:** Are there any cash policies or any policies for accounts or banking?

# Outstanding Questions for Pativoire

1. **Tax Structure:** What is the tax structure that makes Pativoire not have to pay taxes?